WSQ COURSE • TGS-2025060552

Version 3.0 · 10 Oct 2026

Agentic AI for Affiliate Marketing

Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd
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COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome and Learning Contract

How the course runs, what evidence is required and where control boundaries sit

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1

AM

Scan the SSG QR code at the start of each training day.

2

PM

Complete the second attendance event after lunch.

3

Assessment

Complete the separate assessment attendance event before the papers.

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About the Trainer



Your Trainer

General trainer profile template

NAME _____

DESIGNATION _____

QUALIFICATIONS _____

EXPERTISE _____

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TRAINER PROFILE

About the Trainer



Dr Alfred Ang

Principal Trainer · Tertiary Infotech Academy

ROLE	Principal trainer and courseware developer
EXPERTISE	Agentic AI, automation, cloud and secure workflow design
DELIVERY	Technical WSQ courses with evidence-led labs
CONTACT	enquiry@tertiaryinfotech.com

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ICEBREAKER

Let's Know Each Other

1

Role

Your role and the affiliate audiences you support

2

Current stack

Networks, analytics, CRM or content tools you use

3

Goal

One affiliate process you want to improve safely

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LEARNING CONTRACT

Ground Rules

1 Participate

Ask, challenge and test claims with evidence

2 Protect data

Use sample partners; never expose credentials or customer PII

3 Respect controls

Do not publish, message or spend without approval

4 Stay on time

Return promptly from breaks

5 Work independently

Assessment evidence must be your own

6 Attendance

At least 75% attendance is required

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VISUAL PORTAL FLOW

Download Course Material

1

Sign in to lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com

2

Open this course run

3

Download slides, Learner Guide and lab package

4

Keep materials available for the open-book assessment

Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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SCHEDULE · 16 HOURS

Two-Day Learning Journey

1

Day 1 AM

Offer economics, market evidence and trend Skill

2

Day 1 PM

Partner discovery, due diligence and portfolio design

3

Day 2 AM

Campaign factory, tracking and compliance controls

4

Day 2 PM

Commission reconciliation, reporting, optimisation and assessment

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WSQ ALIGNMENT

Skills Framework

1

TSC title

Affiliate Marketing-2

2

TSC code

RET-OTO-2001-1.1

3

Course duration

2 days · 16 training hours

4

Assessment

WA 60 min + Case Study 60 min · open book

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WHAT YOU WILL BE ABLE TO DO

Learning Outcomes

1

LO1

Analyse trends and update partners on products and services

2

LO2

Research, coordinate and construct an effective affiliate portfolio

3

LO3

Report campaign performance, align strategy and maintain compliance

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THREE ALIGNED TOPICS

Course Outline

1

Topic 1

Affiliate research, offer economics, Claude Cowork and reusable Skills

2

Topic 2

MCP-assisted partner due diligence, portfolio design and communication

3

Topic 3

Campaign tracking, compliance, commission reconciliation and reporting

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ASSESSMENT MAP

Knowledge and Ability Coverage

1

K1, K5, K6

Incentives, products and current trends

2

K2, K3, K7

Strategy, relationships and portfolio principles

3

K4, K8, K9

Campaign management, policy and marketing alignment

4

A1, A5

Current practice and product updates

5

A2, A3

Partner coordination and background research

6

A4

Progress, commission and activity reporting

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BEFORE ASSESSMENT

Briefing for Assessment

1 Materials

Open book: slides, Learner Guide and approved files only

2 Conduct

No discussion, photography or recording

3 Submission

Complete and upload on the LMS as instructed

4 Decision

All prescribed assessment requirements must be competent

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OPEN-BOOK ASSESSMENT

Assessment Instruments

WA-SAQ · 60 minutes

- ✓ Three open-ended LO-grouped questions
- ✓ Covers every K1-K9 criterion
- ✓ Answer every question

Case Study · 60 minutes

- ✓ One scenario with three tasks
- ✓ Covers every A1-A5 criterion
- ✓ Apply the six lab methods

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WA -> CS -> SIGN-OFF

Assessment Flow

1. **TRAQOM attendance**
2. **Assessment digital attendance**
3. **Sit WA then Case Study**
4. **Upload completed answers on LMS**
5. **Sign Assessment Summary Record**

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LEARNER REPOSITORY

Access the Hands-On Labs

Option A · Clone

git clone https://github.com/tertiarycourses/TGS-2025060552-Agentic-AI-for-Affiliate-Marketing.git

Option B · Download ZIP

GitHub · Code · Download ZIP

https://github.com/tertiarycourses/TGS-2025060552-Agentic-AI-for-Affiliate-Marketing

Each lab is self-contained. Detailed procedures and evidence checks live in the lab README and Learner Guide.

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TECHNICAL CORE

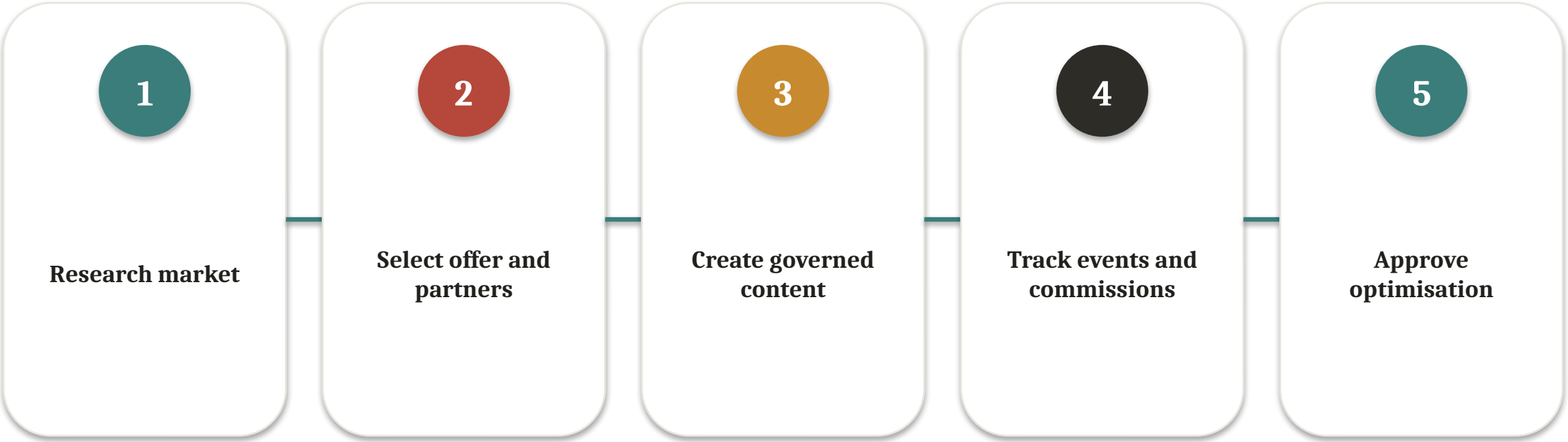
The Controlled Campaign Loop

Architecture, state, autonomy, evidence and failure controls

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RUNTIME TRACE

The Controlled Affiliate Growth Loop



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COMPARE

Automation, Generative AI and Agents

Deterministic automation

- ✓ Fixed path and validation
- ✓ Reliable calculations and writes
- ✓ Best for identifiers and money

Agentic layer

- ✓ Plans bounded research
- ✓ Chooses approved tools
- ✓ Must not own irreversible release

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

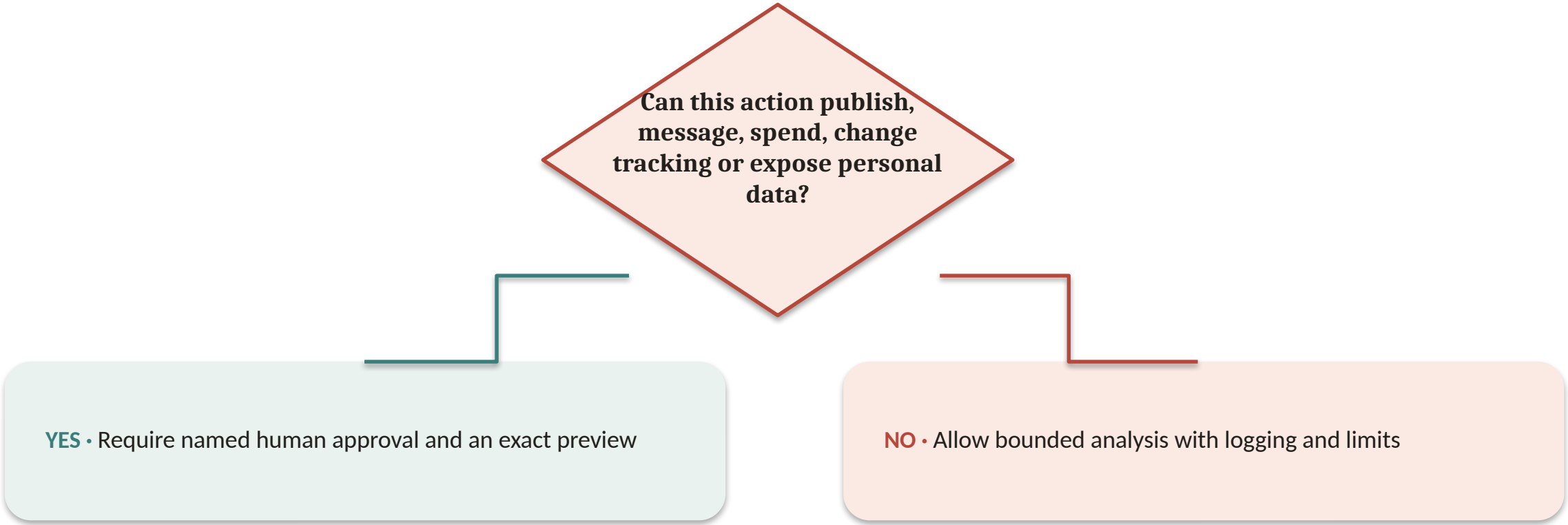
Campaign State Is a Contract

campaign_id	stable correlation key
brief_version	monotonic approved revision
status	draft | review | approved | live
approval_hash	binds decision to exact payload
source_ids	evidence behind claims
evidence_uri	audit and assessment artifact

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DECISION RULE

Autonomy Boundary



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WORKED CALCULATION

Affiliate Value Equation

Profit = attributed revenue - commission - media cost - platform cost - returns

REALISTIC INPUTS

$18,000 - $2,700 - $3,500 - $500 - $900 = $10,400

DECISION

Revenue alone cannot tell whether an affiliate programme creates value.

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MODEL

Five Planes of the System

1 **Strategy**

goals, audience, offer and policy

2 **Partner**

profiles, terms and communications

3 **Content**

claims, channels and tracked links

4 **Evidence**

events, metrics and commission ledger

5 **Control**

approvals, limits and audit trail

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EVIDENCE

Minimum Agent Audit Record

1 **Evidence 1**

task and run identifiers

2 **Evidence 2**

input brief version

3 **Evidence 3**

source IDs and timestamps

4 **Evidence 4**

agent output and validation

5 **Evidence 5**

human decision and payload hash

6 **Evidence 6**

external response or report artifact

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FAILURE CONTROL

Failure Taxonomy Before the Build

Evidence	unsupported or stale source
Partner	fraud, mismatch or concentration
Content	claim, disclosure or brand failure
Attribution	duplicate, missing or misassigned event
Operations	credential leak or unapproved action

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01

TOPIC 01

Affiliate Research and Campaign Planning with Claude Cowork

Market signals -> offer economics -> reusable research Skill -> evidence-led partner update

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LO1 | K1, K5, K6 | A1, A5

Topic 01 Coverage

1

Mechanism 1

Model incentive economics with EPC, conversion, commission and break-even thresholds.

2

Mechanism 2

Separate observed market evidence from agent inference and partner-facing recommendations.

3

Mechanism 3

Package repeatable affiliate research and product-update work as a bounded Claude Skill.

4

Mechanism 4

Use human review to control claims, pricing, disclosure, data use and external communication.

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VISUAL MODEL

Research Specialists Propose; Humans Decide



Trend researcher
evidence and change

Partner scout
audience and fit

Offer evaluator
economics and risk

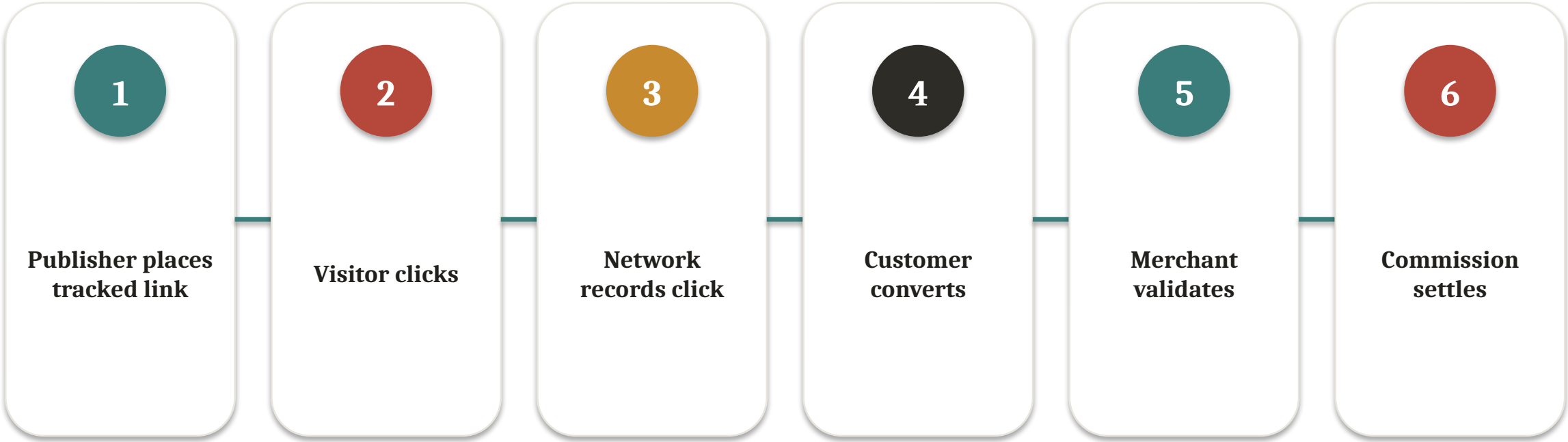
Content planner
channel and message

Human owner
approve exact brief

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RUNTIME TRACE

Affiliate Transaction Runtime

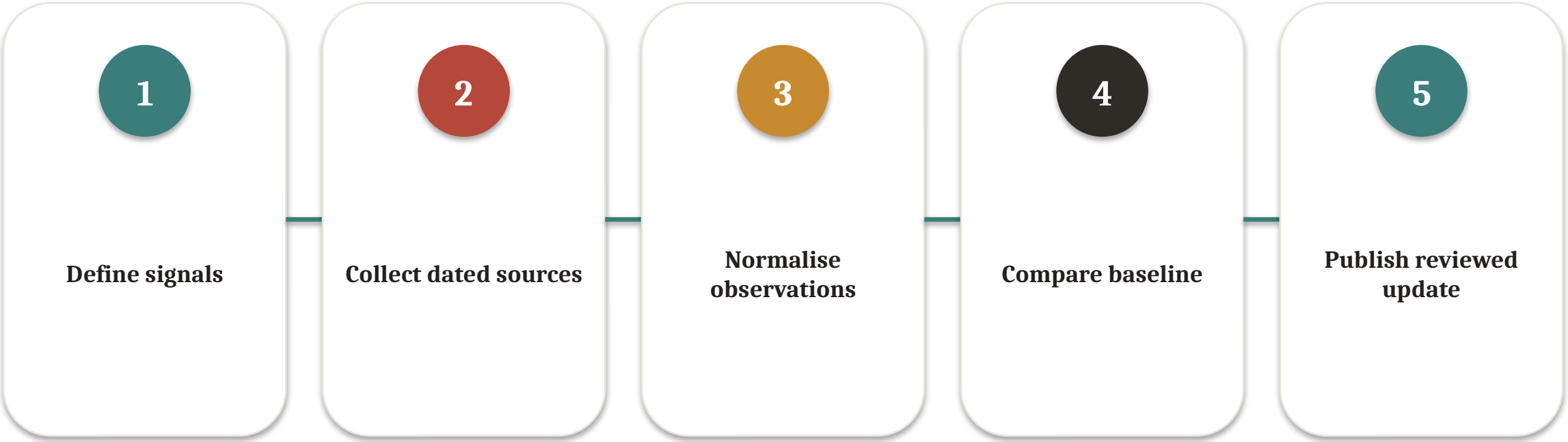


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RUNTIME TRACE

Trend Monitoring Cycle

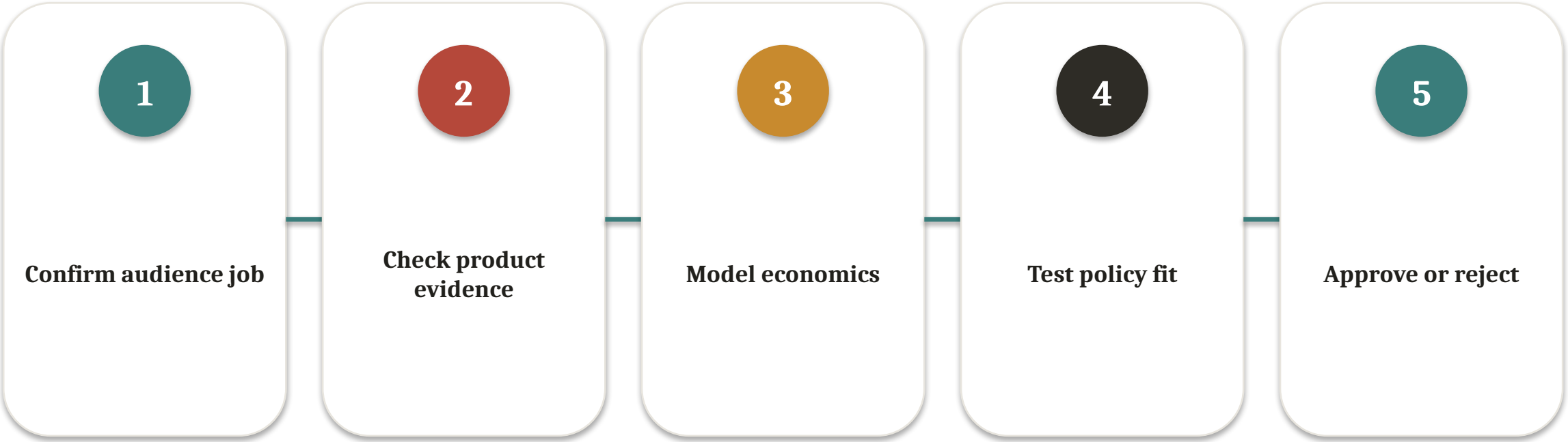


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RUNTIME TRACE

Offer Evaluation Pipeline



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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RUNTIME TRACE

Claude Cowork Research Workflow



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RUNTIME TRACE

Reusable Skill Execution

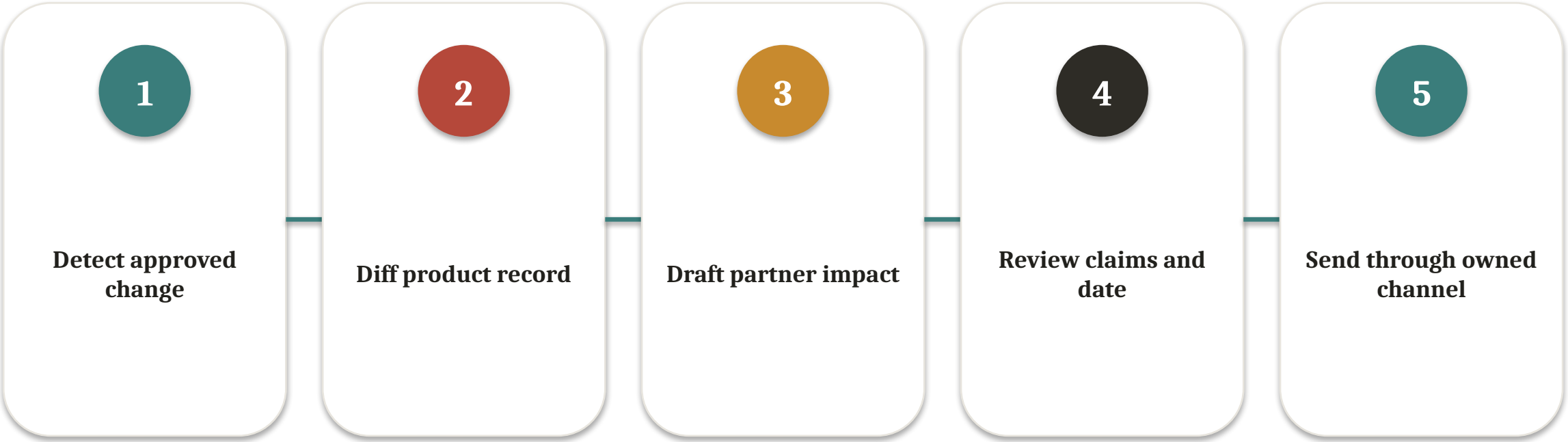


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RUNTIME TRACE

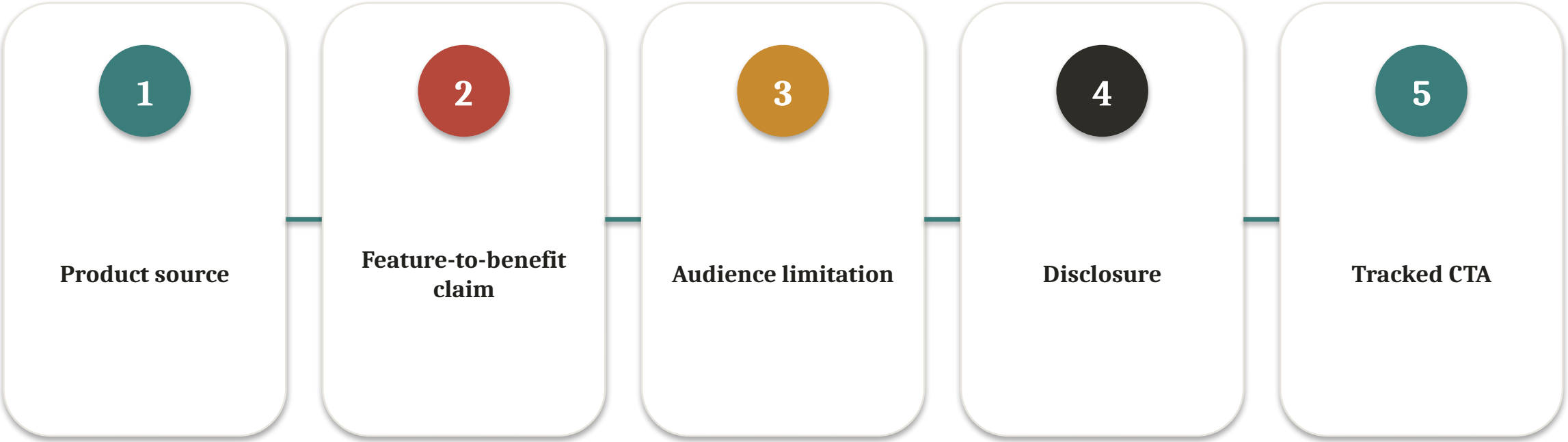
Product Update Communication



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Review Content Evidence Chain

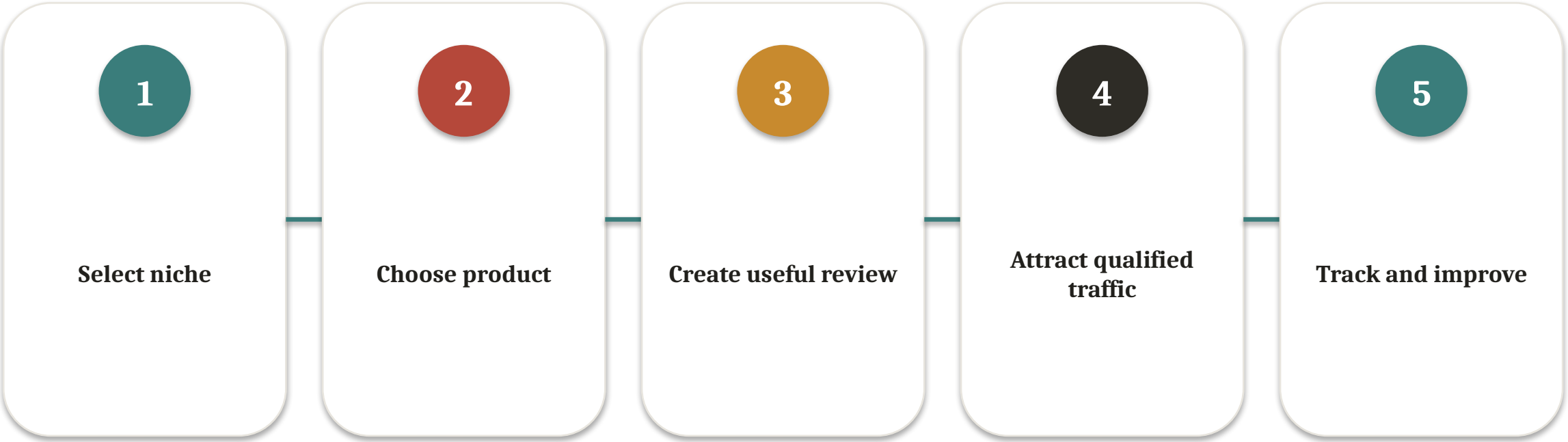


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RUNTIME TRACE

From Ebook Foundation to Current Practice



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Offer Evaluation Record

offer_id	stable product or service key
commission_model	CPS | CPA | CPL | recurring
commission_value	rate or fixed amount
cookie_window_days	attribution eligibility
refund_window_days	reversal exposure
approved_claims	verifiable product proof

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Trend Evidence Card

observation	what changed
source_url	direct evidence
published_at	source date
captured_at	research date
confidence	low | medium | high
implication	bounded partner action

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Affiliate Content Brief

audience_job	problem and context
angle	one defensible promise
disclosure	clear affiliate relationship
offer	approved product version
proof_ids	sources for factual claims
cta	one tracked next step

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Claude Skill Package

SKILL.md	trigger and workflow
templates/	repeatable output shape
references/	approved domain knowledge
scripts/	deterministic checks
examples/	quality baseline
version	change and review history

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

MCP Research Tool Contract

tool_name	intent-specific action
input_schema	allowed query fields
permission	read-only by default
output_schema	evidence and source IDs
timeout	bounded execution
audit_id	traceable invocation

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Product Change Record

product_id	stable catalogue key
changed_fields	price, terms, feature or availability
assets_version	approved creative set
effective_at	when the change applies
partner_impact	what affiliates must change
owner	accountable approver

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Source Allow-List

domain	approved source owner
source_type	product, policy, market or partner
freshness_days	maximum acceptable age
claims_allowed	supported statement classes
pii_rule	data-handling boundary
review_owner	human source steward

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WORKED CALCULATION

Earnings per Click

EPC = affiliate commission / unique tracked clicks

REALISTIC INPUTS

$1,260 commission / 4,200 clicks = $0.30 EPC

DECISION

Compare offers only when the attribution window and traffic quality are comparable.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Conversion Rate

Conversion rate = approved conversions / unique clicks

REALISTIC INPUTS

168 approved orders / 4,200 clicks = 4.0%

DECISION

Use approved conversions after cancellations, not raw checkout events.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Expected Commission

Expected commission = clicks x conversion rate x average order value x commission rate

REALISTIC INPUTS

5,000 x 3.2% x $140 x 12% = $2,688

DECISION

Every assumption needs a source or a sensitivity range.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Break-Even CPC

Break-even CPC = conversion rate x order value x commission rate

REALISTIC INPUTS

0.032 x $140 x 0.12 = $0.5376

DECISION

Paid traffic above $0.54 per click loses money before overhead and reversals.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Refund-Adjusted EPC

Adjusted EPC = gross commission x (1 - reversal rate) / unique clicks

REALISTIC INPUTS

$1,260 x 0.91 / 4,200 = $0.273

DECISION

A high headline commission can hide costly reversals.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Content Payback

Payback clicks = content cost / expected EPC

REALISTIC INPUTS

$900 article / $0.30 EPC = 3,000 clicks

DECISION

Use incremental qualified clicks, not page views, for payback.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Trend Priority Score

Priority = relevance x confidence x urgency / effort

REALISTIC INPUTS

4 x 3 x 4 / 2 = 24

DECISION

The score ranks research follow-up; it does not make a claim true.

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COMPARE

CPS, CPA and CPL

Revenue-linked

- ✓ CPS pays after approved sale
- ✓ Aligns with merchant revenue
- ✓ Sensitive to refunds and attribution

Action-linked

- ✓ CPA/CPL pays for defined action
- ✓ Faster feedback
- ✓ Needs strict quality validation

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COMPARE

Recurring vs One-Time Commission

Recurring

- ✓ Rewards retained subscriptions
- ✓ Requires churn and cohort view
- ✓ Longer earnings tail

One-time

- ✓ Simple settlement
- ✓ Fast payback read
- ✓ Can favour short-term acquisition

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COMPARE

Broad Category vs Narrow Niche

Broad

- ✓ Larger possible reach
- ✓ More content competition
- ✓ Weaker audience specificity

Narrow

- ✓ Clearer expertise and intent
- ✓ Smaller reachable market
- ✓ Often stronger conversion quality

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COMPARE

Review Article vs Comparison Page

Review

- ✓ Deep single-offer evidence
- ✓ Supports high-intent query
- ✓ Must disclose limitations

Comparison

- ✓ Makes criteria explicit
- ✓ Supports choice among offers
- ✓ Needs fair and current data

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COMPARE

Owned vs Paid Traffic

Owned

- ✓ SEO, email and community
- ✓ Compounds but takes time
- ✓ Greater message control

Paid

- ✓ Immediate test volume
- ✓ Marginal cost per click
- ✓ Strict break-even control

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COMPARE

Observed Signal vs Agent Inference

Observed

- ✓ Source-dated fact
- ✓ Quantified sample or change
- ✓ Reproducible by reviewer

Inferred

- ✓ Possible explanation
- ✓ Must state uncertainty
- ✓ Requires test before causality

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COMPARE

Manual Prompt vs Reusable Skill

One-off prompt

- ✓ Fast exploration
- ✓ Variable method and format
- ✓ Harder to audit

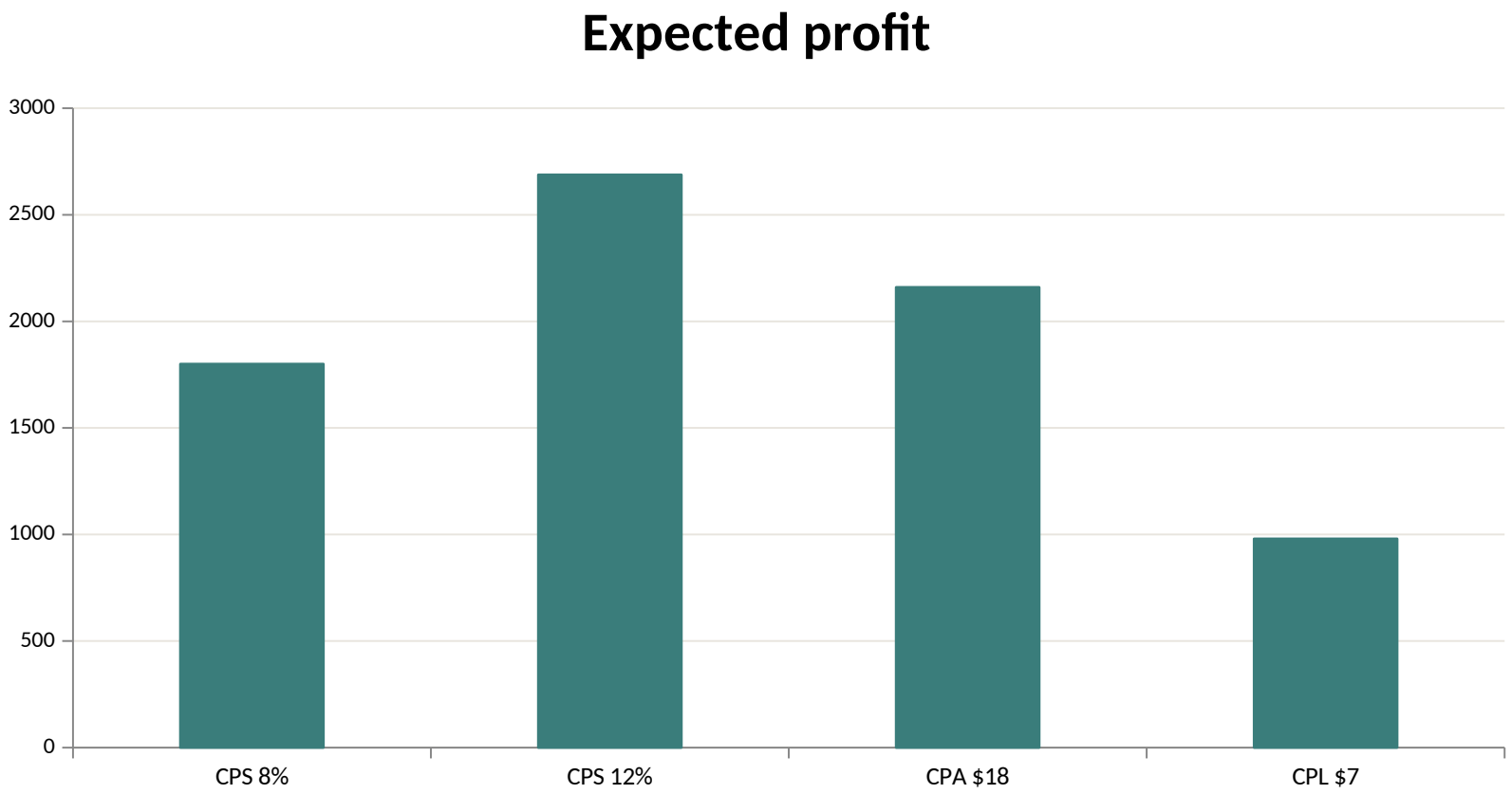
Custom Skill

- ✓ Versioned method and templates
- ✓ Repeatable acceptance checks
- ✓ Reusable across campaigns

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Commission Model Sensitivity



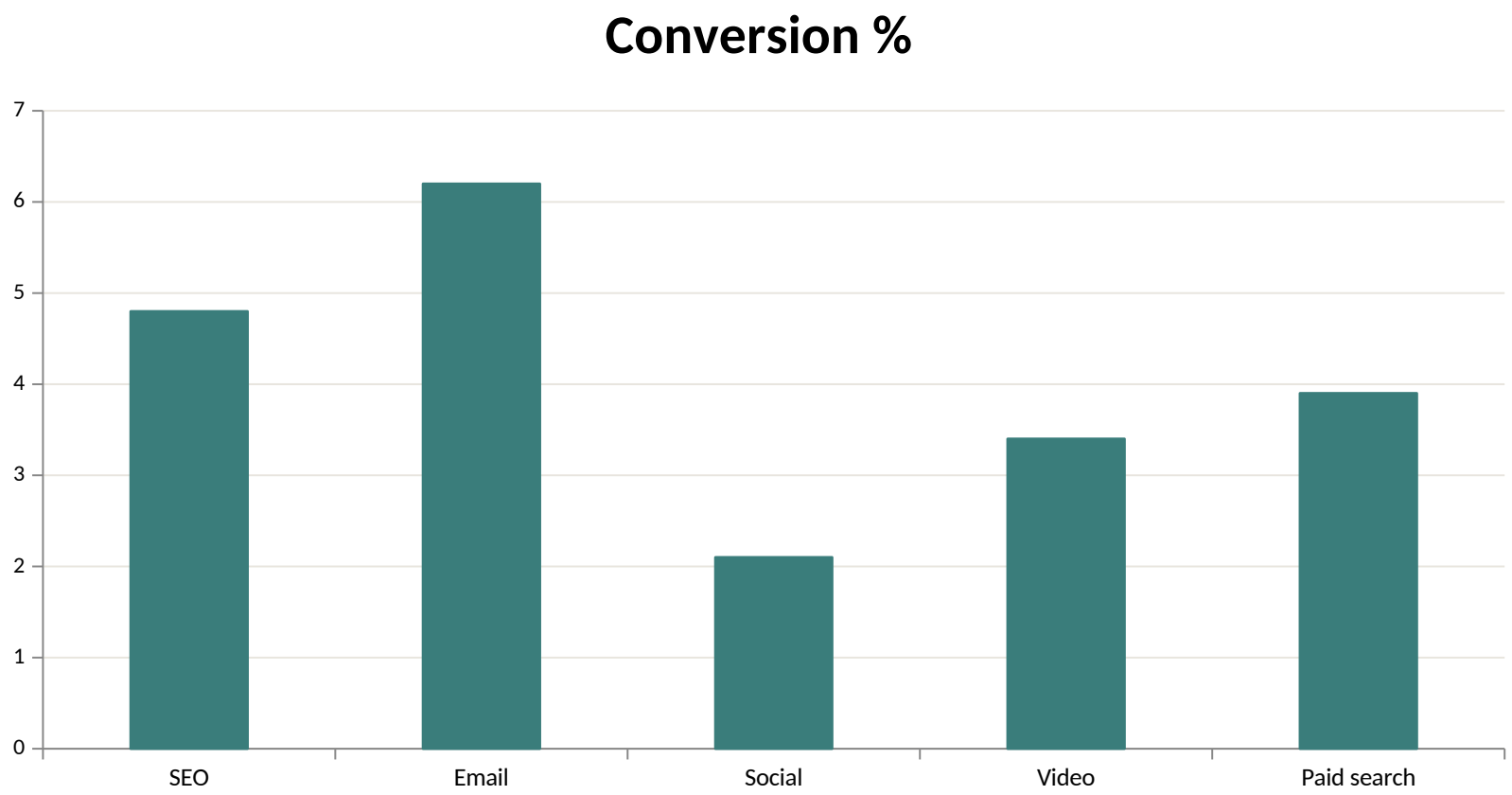
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

The highest rate is not automatically the highest profit; conversion and validation rules dominate.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Traffic Quality by Channel



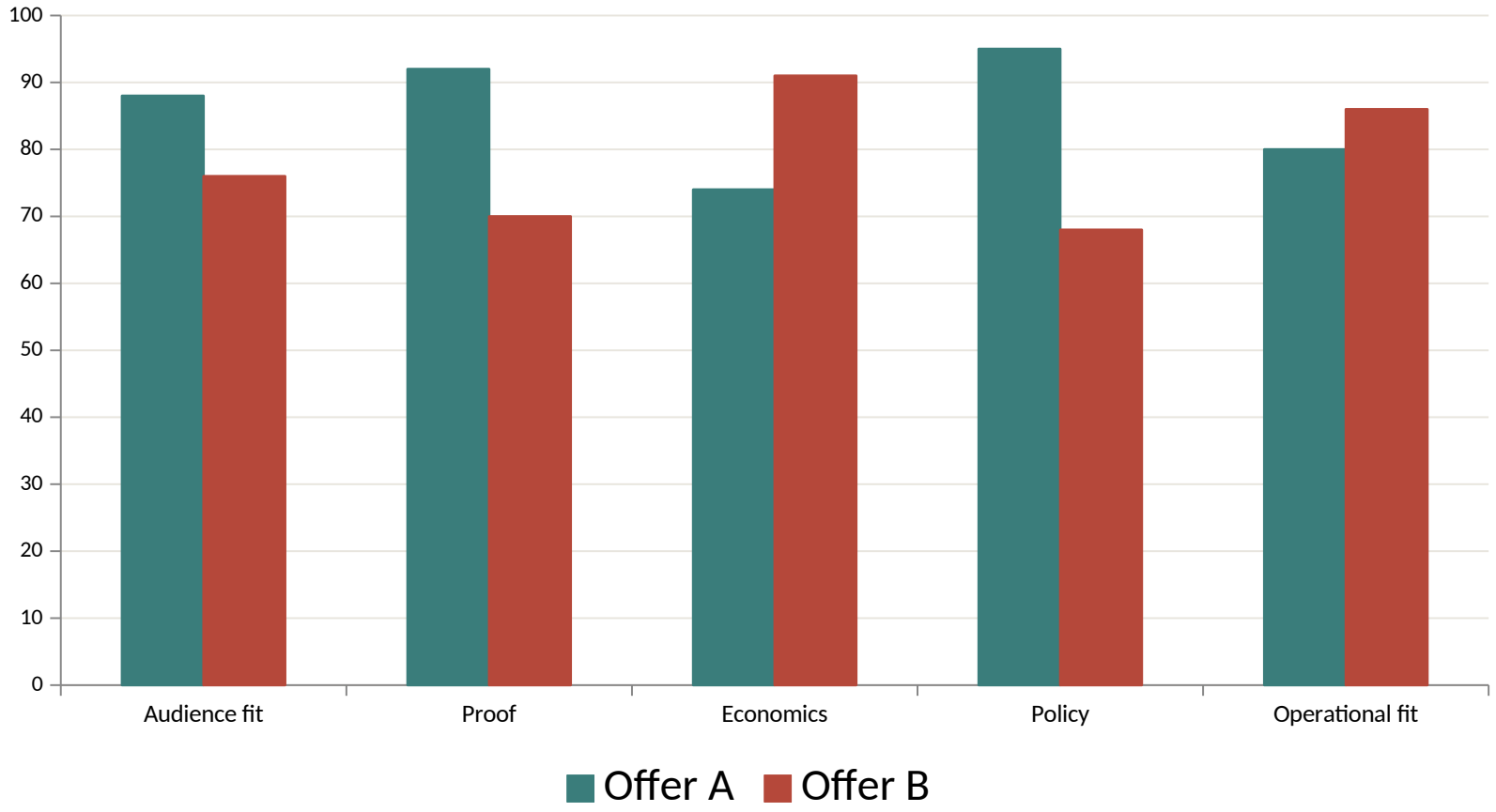
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Email converts best in this teaching set, while social supplies reach but weaker intent.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Offer Scorecard



WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Offer B's economics cannot compensate for a policy score below the release threshold.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Trend Signal Confidence



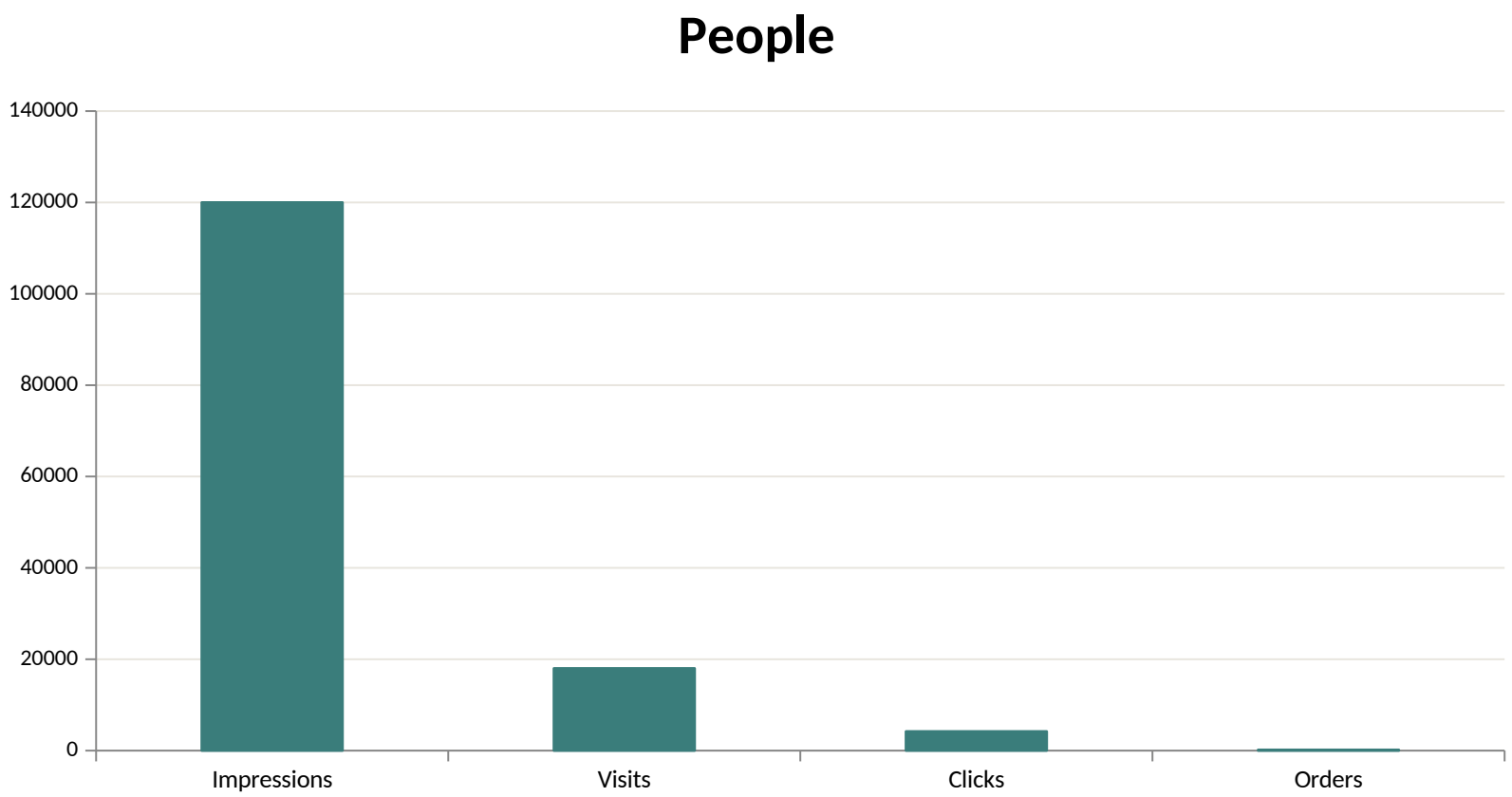
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Confidence rises with independent evidence and direct behavioural data.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Content Funnel Example



WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

The largest absolute drop is visibility to visit; the commercial decision still depends on EPC and cost.

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DECISION RULE

Select an Offer



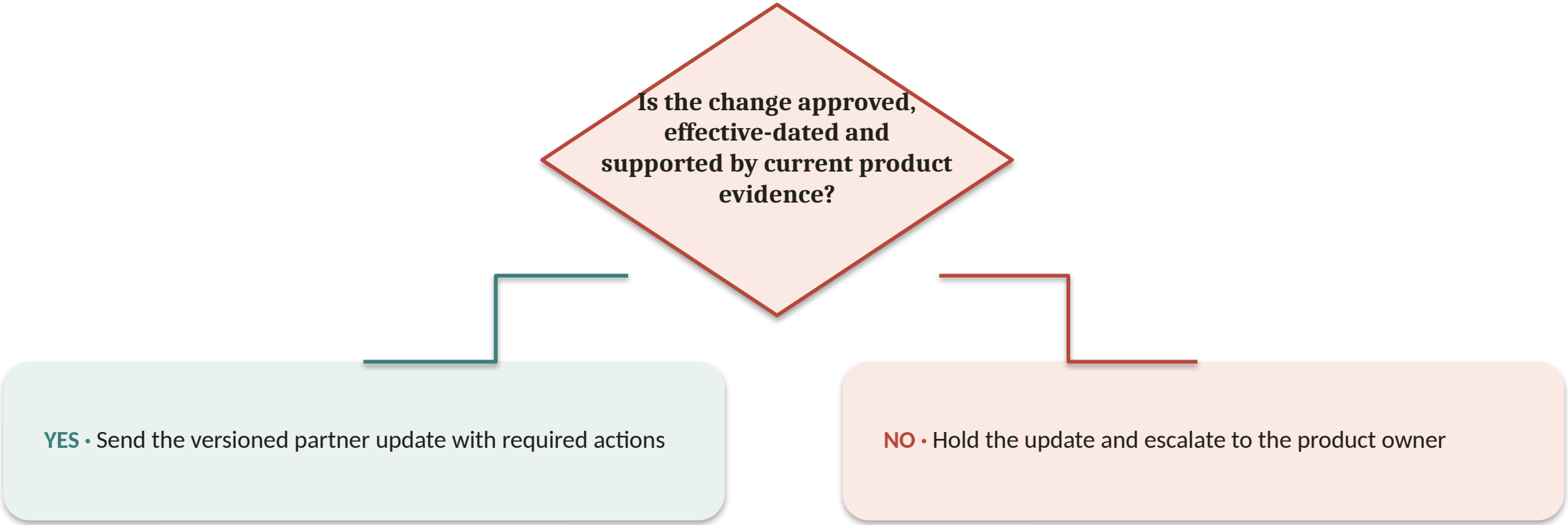
YES · Model expected value and approve a bounded pilot

NO · Reject or request missing evidence; do not average away a hard failure

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DECISION RULE

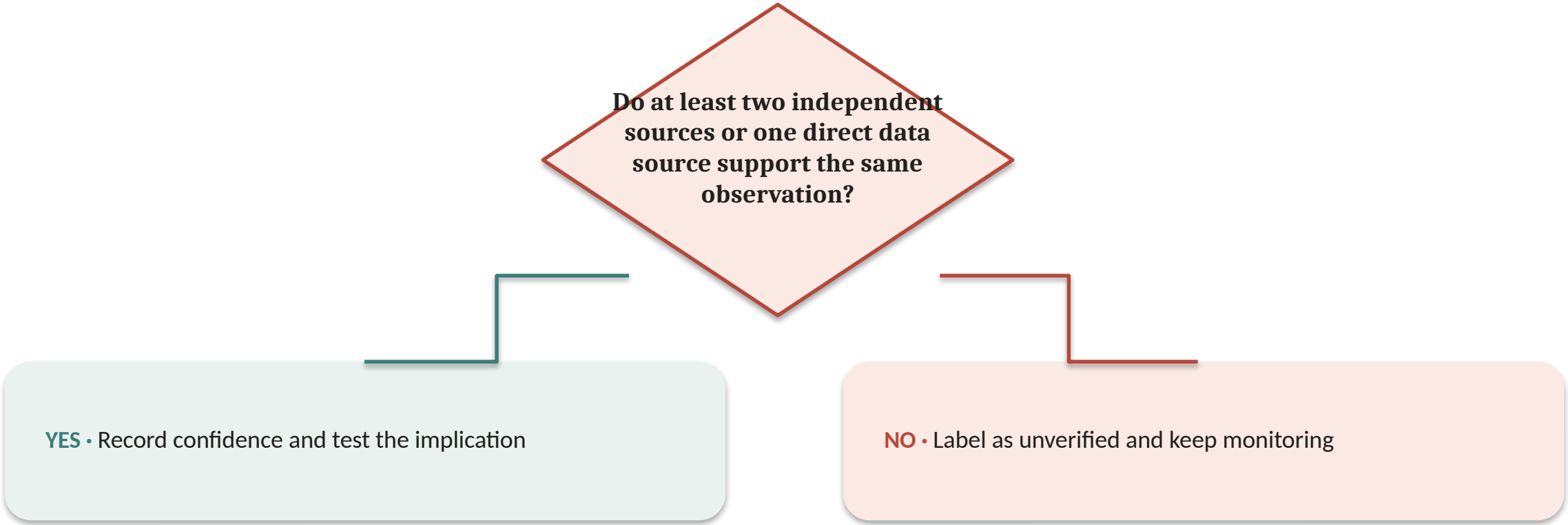
Release a Product Update



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DECISION RULE

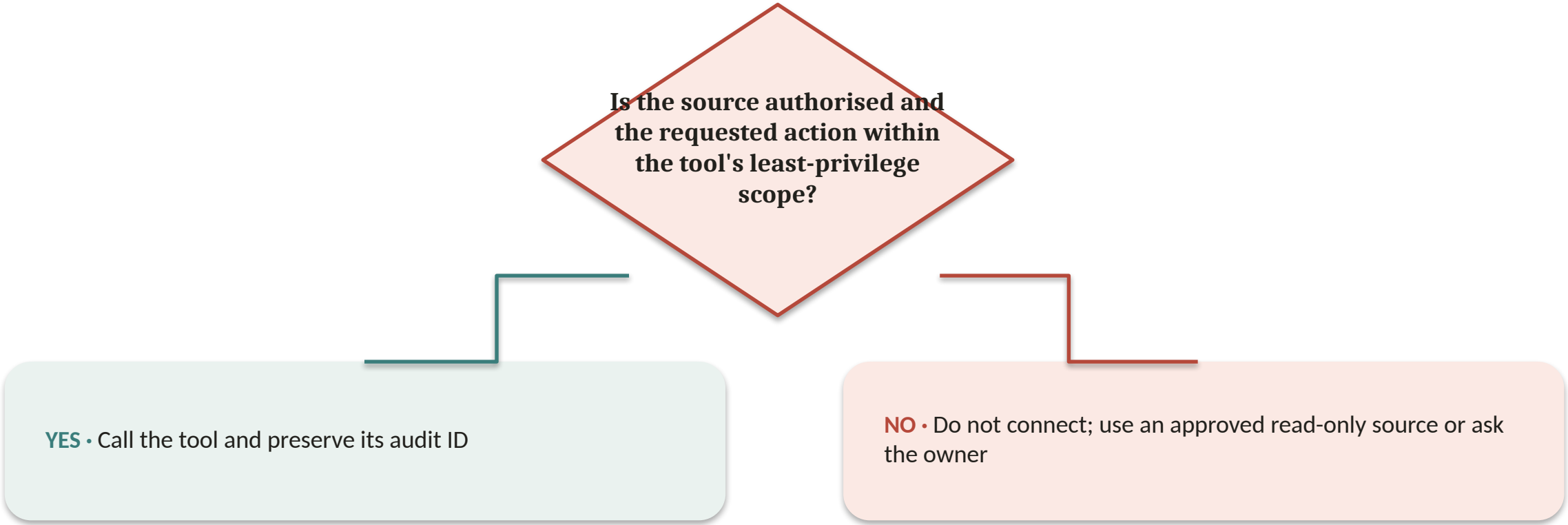
Trust a Trend Claim



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DECISION RULE

Use an MCP Tool



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FAILURE CONTROL

Offer-Selection Failure Modes

Rate bias	choosing the largest commission
Cookie mismatch	ignoring attribution window
Return exposure	using gross conversions
Weak proof	promoting unsupported benefits
Ops mismatch	merchant cannot fulfil demand

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FAILURE CONTROL

Research Failure Modes

Stale source	old trend presented as current
Source laundering	agent answer without direct URL
False consensus	many copies of one claim
Confirmation bias	search framed around desired answer
PII leakage	personal data added to prompts

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Content Failure Modes

Spam	volume without audience value
Wrong words	claims do not match intent
Wrong traffic	reach without qualified demand
Demand error	content solves no real job
Product error	offer does not fit audience

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FAILURE CONTROL

Skill and Connector Controls

Overbroad trigger	Skill runs on unrelated tasks
Hidden write	connector changes external state
Prompt injection	source text overrides workflow
Secret exposure	token appears in output
No version	method changes without review

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EVIDENCE

LO1 Evidence Bundle

1

Evidence 1

offer economics model

2

Evidence 2

dated trend evidence cards

3

Evidence 3

source allow-list

4

Evidence 4

custom research Skill

5

Evidence 5

product update brief

6

Evidence 6

human approval record

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EVIDENCE

Ebook Foundation Trace

1

Evidence 1

product and niche criteria

2

Evidence 2

EPC and conversion tracking

3

Evidence 3

review-writing structure

4

Evidence 4

SEO, email, social and video channels

5

Evidence 5

branding and audience fit

6

Evidence 6

spam and traffic-quality mistakes

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01

LAB 1

Affiliate Offer Economics and Niche Fit

LO1 | K1, K5, K6 · 75 minutes

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PRACTICE BRIDGE

Lab 1 Scenario

1 Business need

Evaluate three retail and hospitality offers using the ebook-derived product criteria, current evidence, EPC, conversion, reversal and break-even models.

2 Deliverable

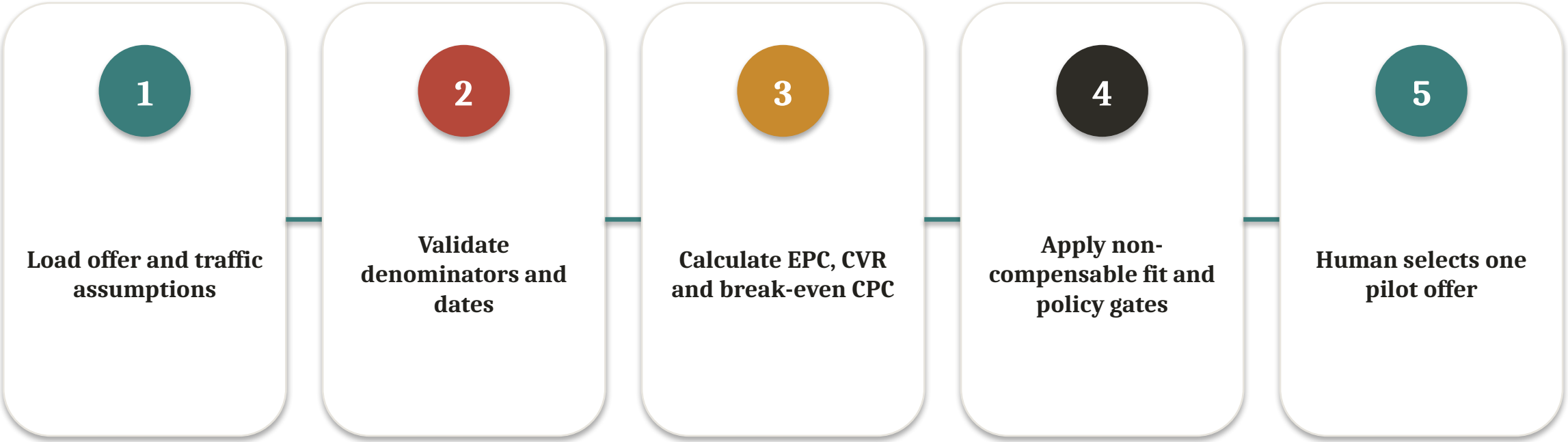
A source-backed offer scorecard and deterministic economics report.

3 Tool boundary

Claude Cowork, spreadsheet/CSV, Python calculator, supplied product evidence

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Lab 1 Runtime Mechanism



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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WHAT MUST REMAIN TRUE

Lab 1 Concrete Contract

Rule 1	unique clicks are the EPC denominator
Rule 2	approved conversions exclude reversals
Rule 3	commission terms are effective-dated
Rule 4	every qualitative score cites evidence
Rule 5	hard policy gates run before ranking

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WHAT TO CAPTURE

Lab 1 Evidence Package

1 Evidence 1

completed offer-inputs.csv

2 Evidence 2

offer-economics-report.md

3 Evidence 3

source notes

4 Evidence 4

selected offer and rationale

5 Evidence 5

one rejected offer with gate reason

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TEST WITHOUT CLICK PATHS

Lab 1 Verification and Failure

Accept

- ✓ all numeric metrics recompute
- ✓ source dates recorded
- ✓ hard gates applied before ranking
- ✓ pilot has CPC ceiling
- ✓ no unsupported claim

Diagnose

- ✓ missing denominator blocks calculation
- ✓ stale product evidence lowers confidence
- ✓ high rate cannot offset poor audience fit
- ✓ negative margin rejects paid traffic

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02

LAB 2

Trend Monitor and Product Update Skill

LO1 | A1, A5 · 90 minutes

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PRACTICE BRIDGE

Lab 2 Scenario

1 Business need

Create a reusable Claude Skill that turns approved trend signals and product changes into evidence cards and a reviewed affiliate update.

2 Deliverable

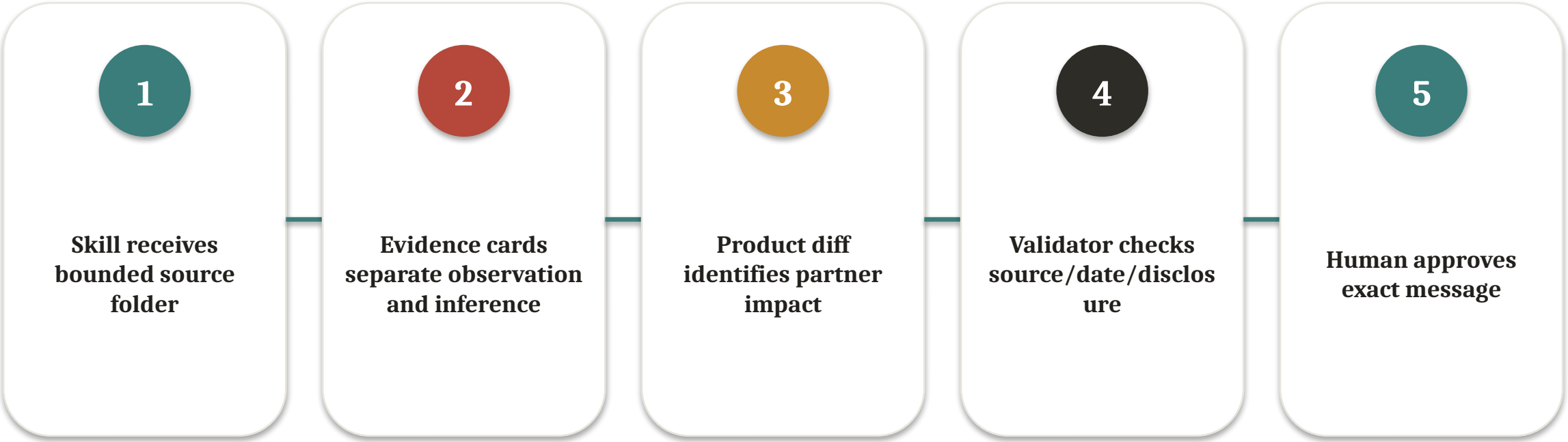
A packaged custom Skill, trend evidence set and versioned product-update brief.

3 Tool boundary

Claude Cowork, custom Skills, approved web sources, Markdown templates

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Lab 2 Runtime Mechanism



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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WHAT MUST REMAIN TRUE

Lab 2 Concrete Contract

Rule 1	Skill trigger is narrow
Rule 2	every observation has source and date
Rule 3	product facts come from approved catalogue
Rule 4	inference is labelled
Rule 5	outbound update requires human approval

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WHAT TO CAPTURE

Lab 2 Evidence Package

1

Evidence 1

skills/affiliate-trend-update/SKILL.md

2

Evidence 2

completed evidence cards

3

Evidence 3

product diff

4

Evidence 4

approved partner update

5

Evidence 5

validator result

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Lab 2 Verification and Failure

Accept

- ✓ Skill package is valid
- ✓ sources and dates present
- ✓ fact and inference separated
- ✓ product impact explicit
- ✓ human approval recorded

Diagnose

- ✓ single-source trend remains low confidence
- ✓ missing effective date blocks product update
- ✓ unsupported claim returns to research
- ✓ prompt injection text is treated as data

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02

TOPIC 02

Affiliate Portfolio and Partner Coordination with Skills and MCP

Partner discovery -> due diligence -> scoring -> portfolio balance -> coordinated communication

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LO2 | K2, K3, K7 | A2, A3

Topic 02 Coverage

1

Mechanism 1

Define partner-fit evidence before allowing an agent to rank candidates.

2

Mechanism 2

Use MCP connectors as permissioned data boundaries, not invisible sources of truth.

3

Mechanism 3

Build a portfolio that balances reach, relevance, conversion quality and concentration risk.

4

Mechanism 4

Coordinate partners through versioned briefs, service levels, escalation and audit evidence.

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VISUAL MODEL

Partner Research Becomes a Governed Portfolio



Discover
bounded candidate universe

Verify
identity and audience evidence

Score
transparent criteria

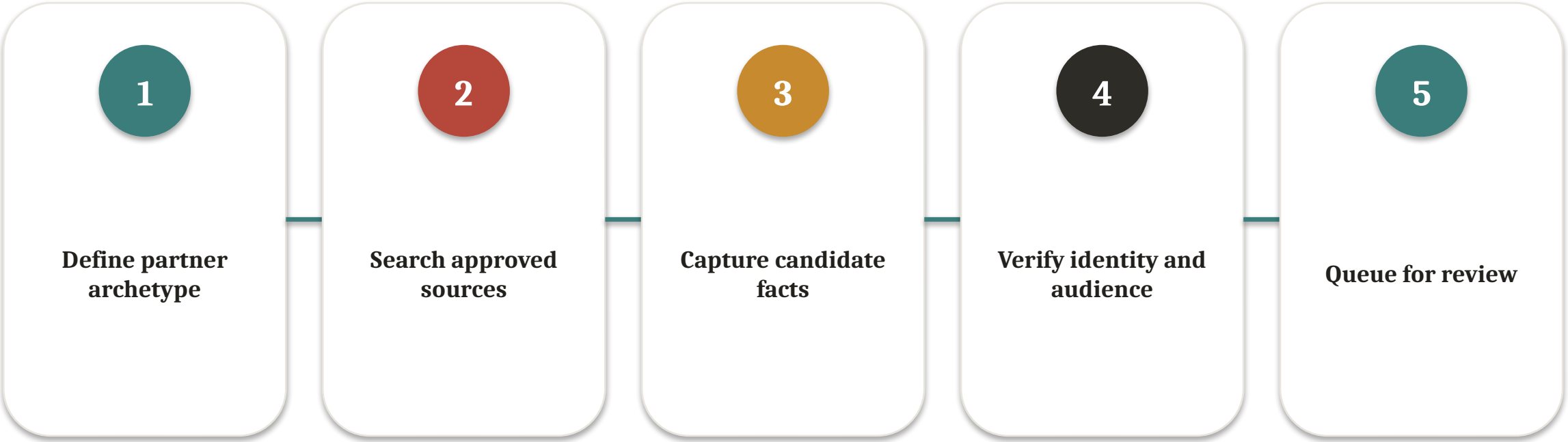
Balance
reach and concentration

Coordinate
briefs, cadence and escalation

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RUNTIME TRACE

Partner Discovery Runtime

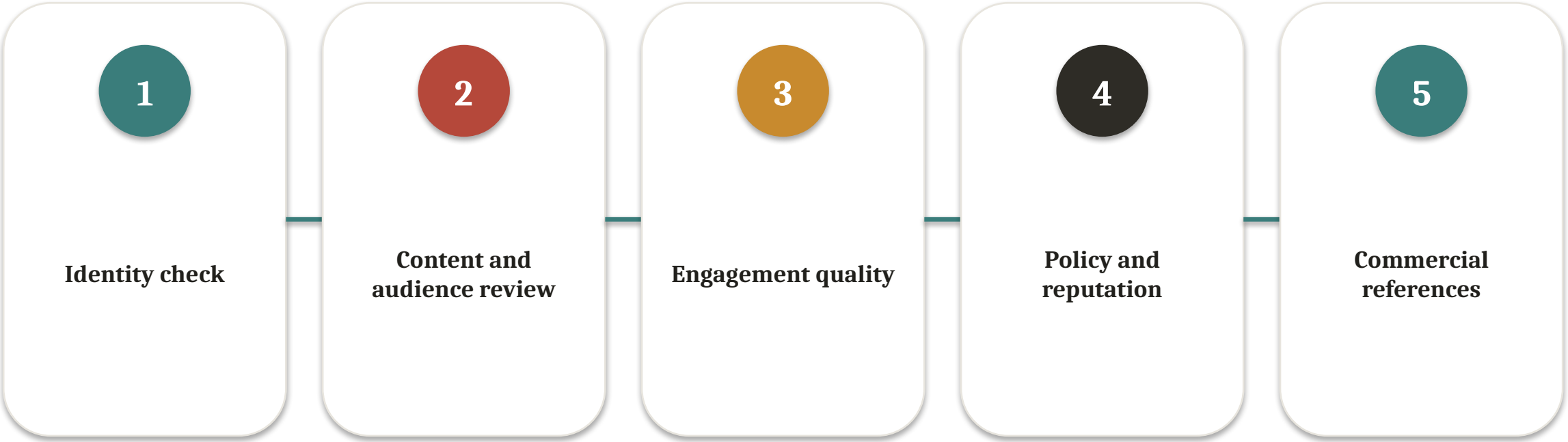


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RUNTIME TRACE

Due-Diligence Workflow

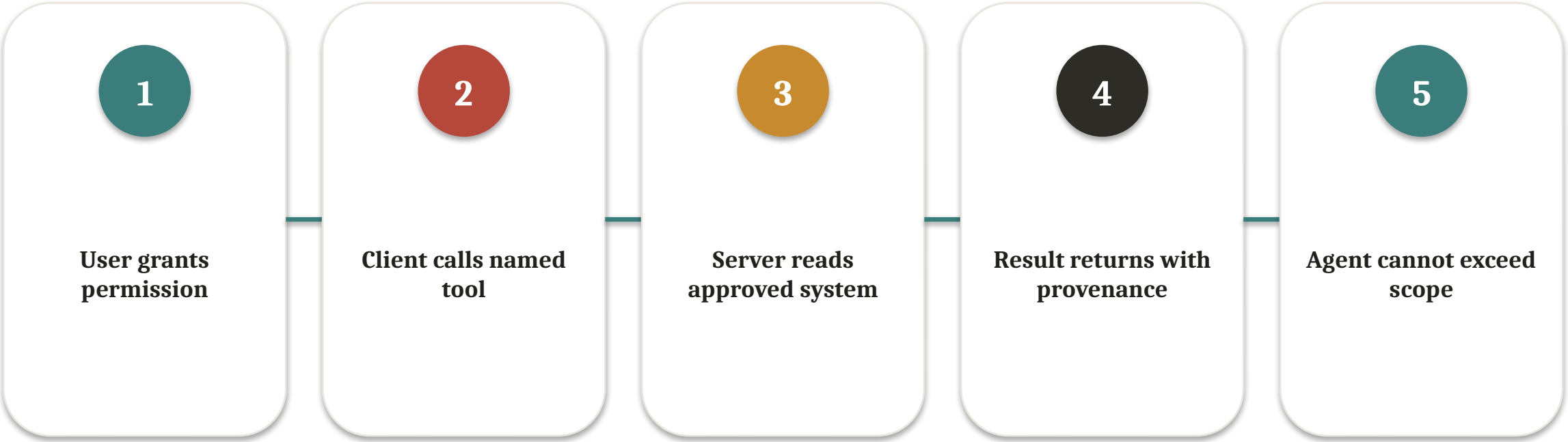


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RUNTIME TRACE

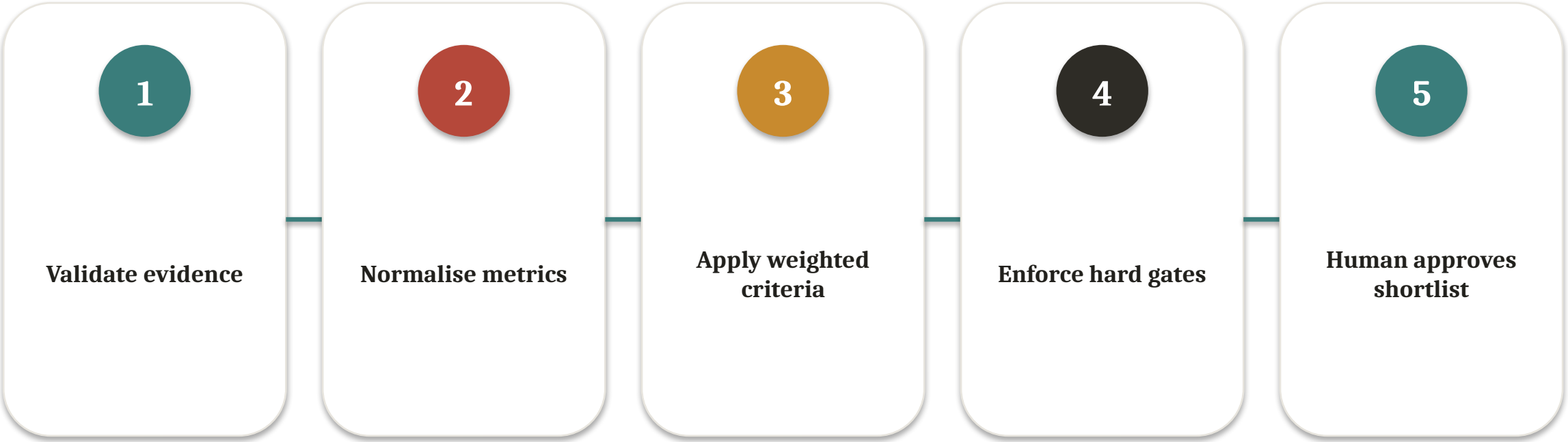
MCP Connector Boundary



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Candidate Scoring Pipeline

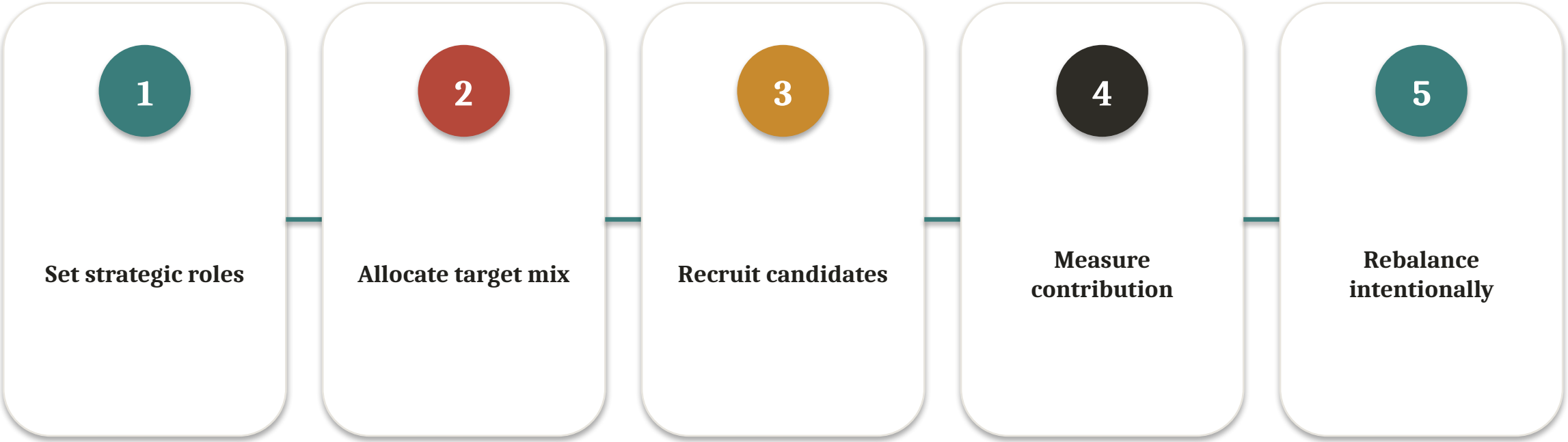


Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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RUNTIME TRACE

Portfolio Construction Cycle

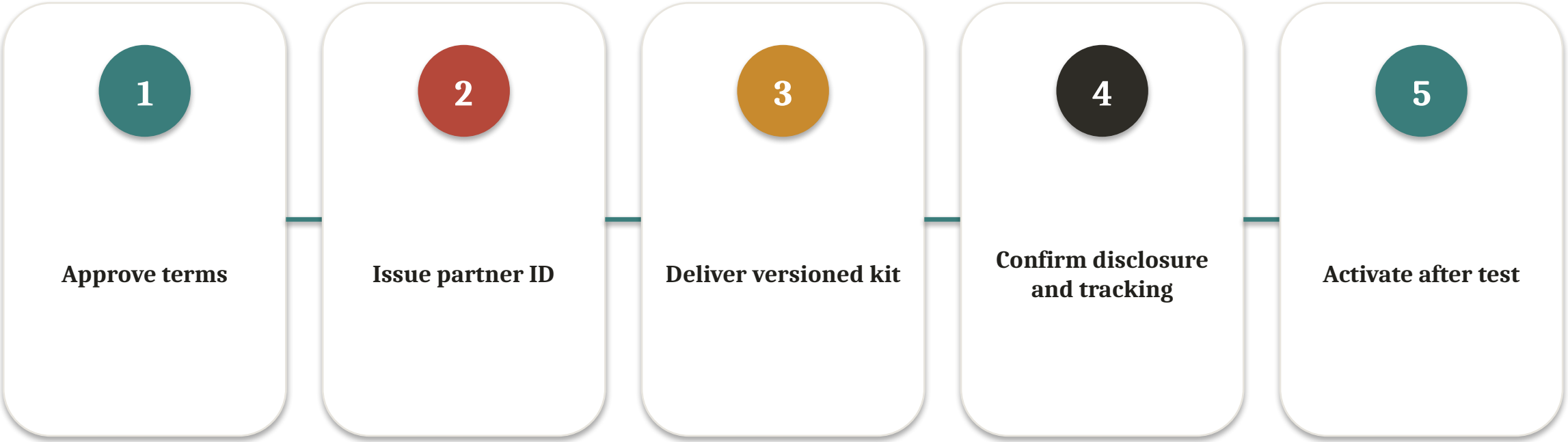


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RUNTIME TRACE

Partner Onboarding Flow

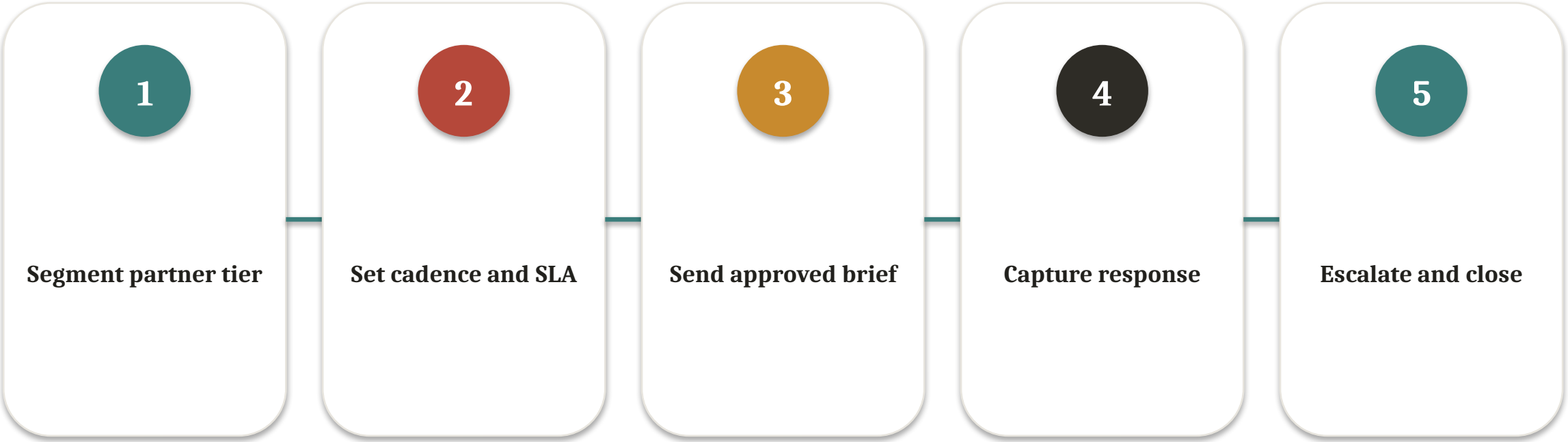


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RUNTIME TRACE

Communication Control Loop



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Affiliate Candidate Record

partner_id	stable internal key
audience_profile	region, need and channel
policy_flags	disclosure and brand risks
identity_urls	verified public identities
engagement_evidence	dated sample and denominator
source_ids	traceable background evidence

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Partner Scorecard Contract

criterion	named decision dimension
weight	sums to 100%
raw_evidence	source-backed input
normalised_score	0-100 scale
hard_gate	non-compensable threshold
reviewer_note	human rationale

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Portfolio Role Taxonomy

role	reach | authority | conversion | retention
audience	priority segment
risk_tier	monitoring depth
channel	site, email, social, video or community
offer_fit	approved product family
capacity	campaign and content limit

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Partner Brief Schema

campaign_id	links work to strategy
partner_id	intended recipient
product_version	approved offer facts
mandatory_claims	must-use verified statements
prohibited_claims	cannot publish
tracking_url	unique attribution key

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Communication SLA

tier	strategic | growth | standard
response_target	business-hour commitment
channel	approved contact route
routine_cadence	planned update frequency
escalation_owner	named accountable person
evidence	message and outcome record

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Partner Update Event

event_id	deduplication key
partner_id	recipient identity
message_version	exact approved content
sent_at	timestamp and timezone
acknowledged_at	nullable response time
next_action	owner and due date

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WORKED CALCULATION

Weighted Partner Score

Score = sum(weight x criterion score)

REALISTIC INPUTS

0.30x88 + 0.25x76 + 0.20x92 + 0.15x80 + 0.10x70 = 82.8

DECISION

Apply hard gates before ranking; a policy failure must not be averaged away.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Engagement Rate

Engagement rate = meaningful interactions / reachable audience

REALISTIC INPUTS

1,260 interactions / 42,000 reachable followers = 3.0%

DECISION

Define meaningful interaction and use a recent sample, not lifetime vanity totals.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Portfolio Concentration

Top-3 share = revenue from top 3 partners / total affiliate revenue

REALISTIC INPUTS

$42,000 / $60,000 = 70%

DECISION

A high top-3 share increases outage and negotiation risk even when current ROI is strong.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Response SLA Attainment

SLA attainment = responses within target / support requests

REALISTIC INPUTS

87 / 100 = 87%

DECISION

Segment by partner tier; a blended result can hide failure for strategic partners.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Partner Retention

Retention = active partners at end who were active at start / active partners at start

REALISTIC INPUTS

42 / 50 = 84%

DECISION

Exclude newly recruited partners from the retention numerator and denominator.

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COMPARE

Reach vs Relevance

Reach

- ✓ Large potential audience
- ✓ Useful for awareness
- ✓ May dilute intent

Relevance

- ✓ Strong problem-offer fit
- ✓ Smaller but qualified audience
- ✓ Often better conversion quality

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COMPARE

Follower Count vs Engagement Evidence

Follower count

- ✓ Easy to collect
- ✓ May include inactive or bought accounts
- ✓ Weak behavioural proof

Engagement evidence

- ✓ Sampled denominator
- ✓ Comment and click quality
- ✓ More predictive when current

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COMPARE

Single-Star vs Portfolio Model

Single star

- ✓ Fast coordination
- ✓ High concentration risk
- ✓ One voice and channel

Portfolio

- ✓ Diversified audience and channel
- ✓ Higher operating complexity
- ✓ Needs role and capacity design

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COMPARE

Direct Outreach vs Network Recruitment

Direct

- ✓ Custom terms and relationship
- ✓ Higher research effort
- ✓ Rich strategic fit

Network

- ✓ Faster candidate access
- ✓ Standardised tracking and payout
- ✓ Less direct ownership

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COMPARE

Strategic vs Standard Partner Service

Strategic

- ✓ Joint plan and frequent review
- ✓ Custom assets and escalation
- ✓ High expected contribution

Standard

- ✓ Scalable portal and templates
- ✓ Defined response SLA
- ✓ Lower account-management cost

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COMPARE

Read-Only vs Write-Capable Connector

Read-only

- ✓ Research and retrieval
- ✓ Lower blast radius
- ✓ Default for discovery

Write-capable

- ✓ Messages or record updates
- ✓ Requires preview and approval
- ✓ Narrow fields and allow-lists

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COMPARE

Agent Recommendation vs Human Decision

Agent

- ✓ Synthesises evidence
- ✓ Applies transparent score
- ✓ Surfaces uncertainty

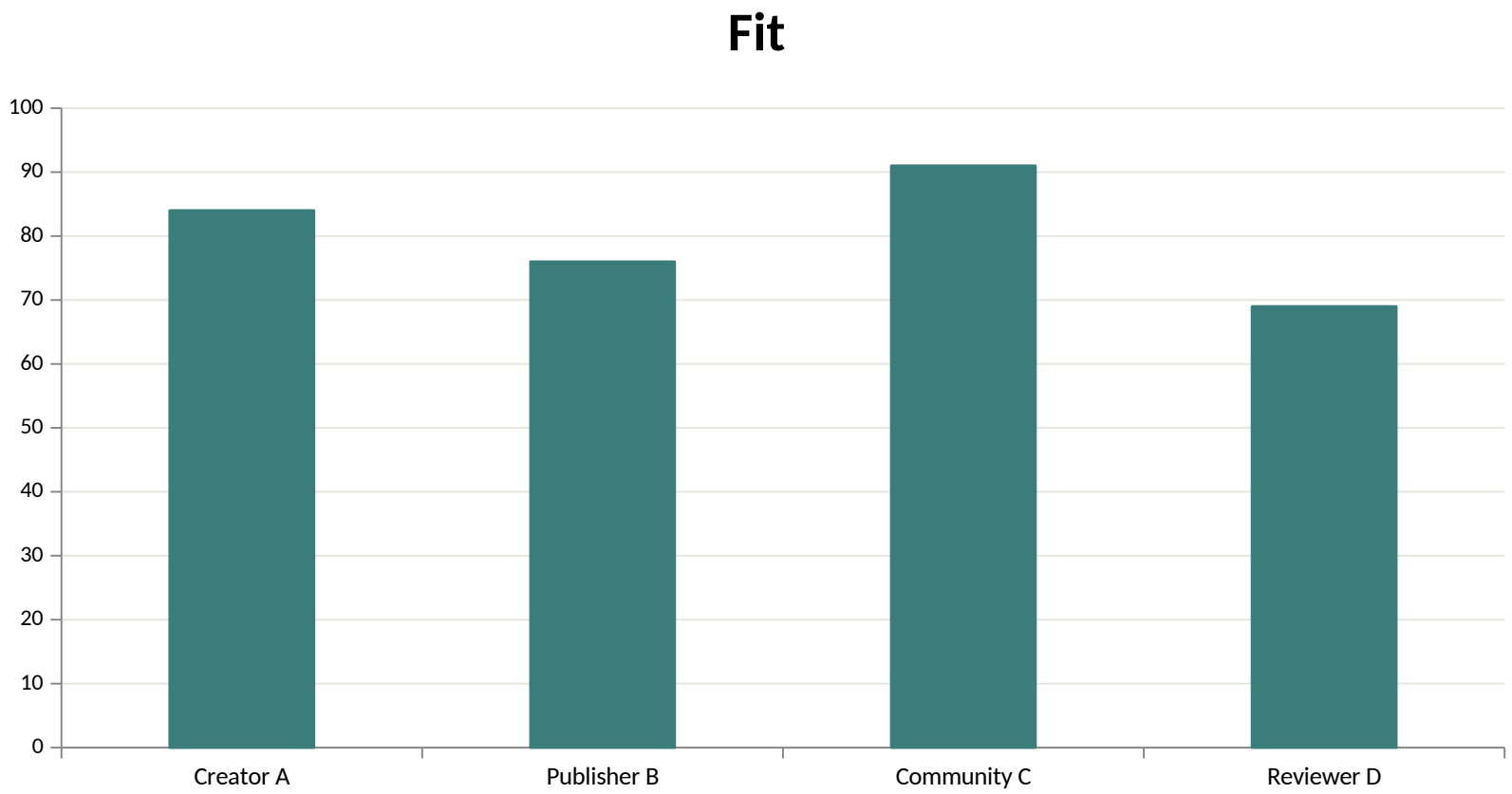
Human owner

- ✓ Judges brand and relationship context
- ✓ Accepts trade-offs
- ✓ Owns invitation and terms

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Candidate Fit Score



WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Community C leads on fit; the next step is due diligence, not automatic recruitment.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Portfolio Mix by Role



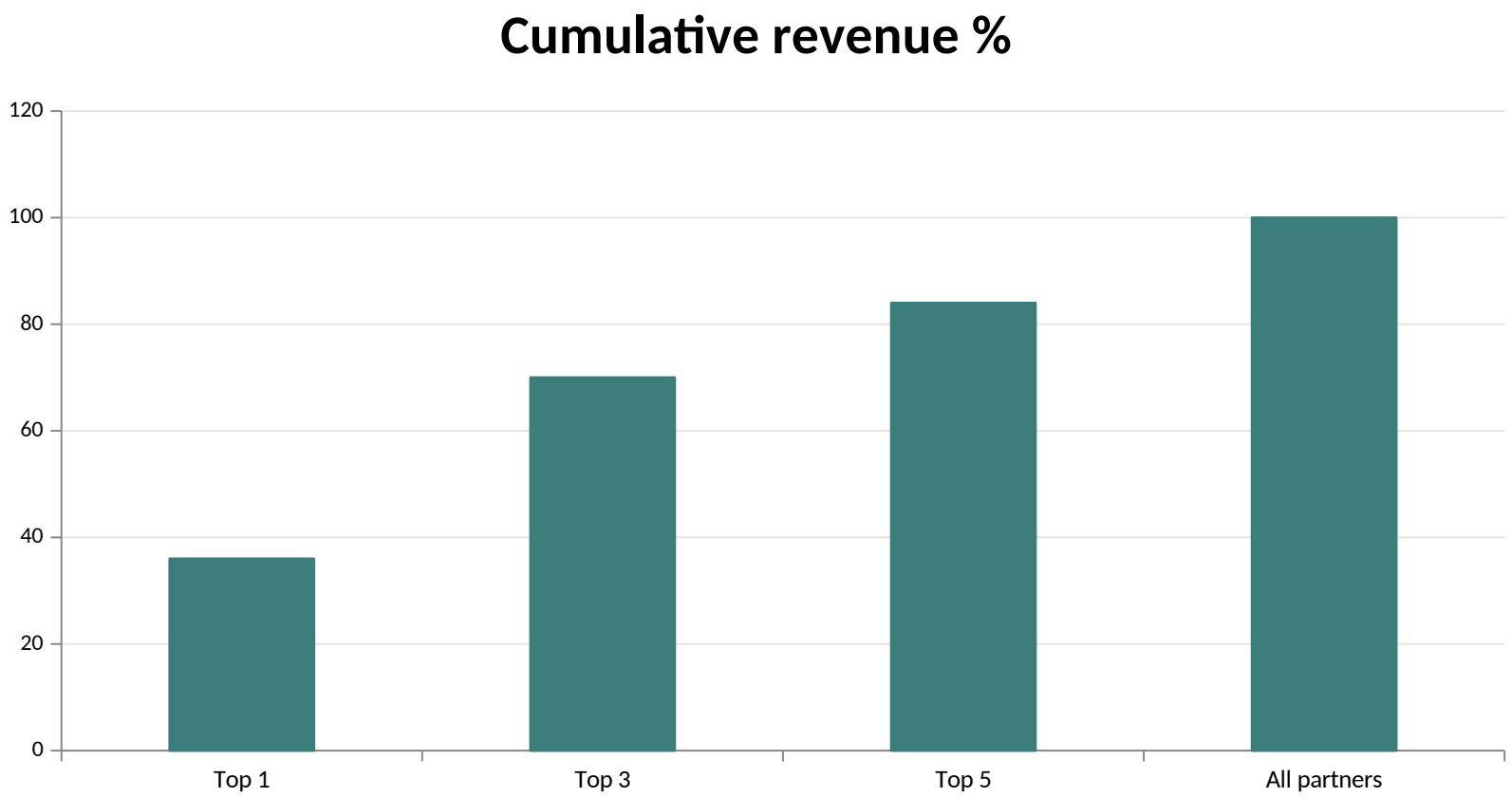
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

The current portfolio overweights reach and underinvests in retention partners.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Revenue Concentration



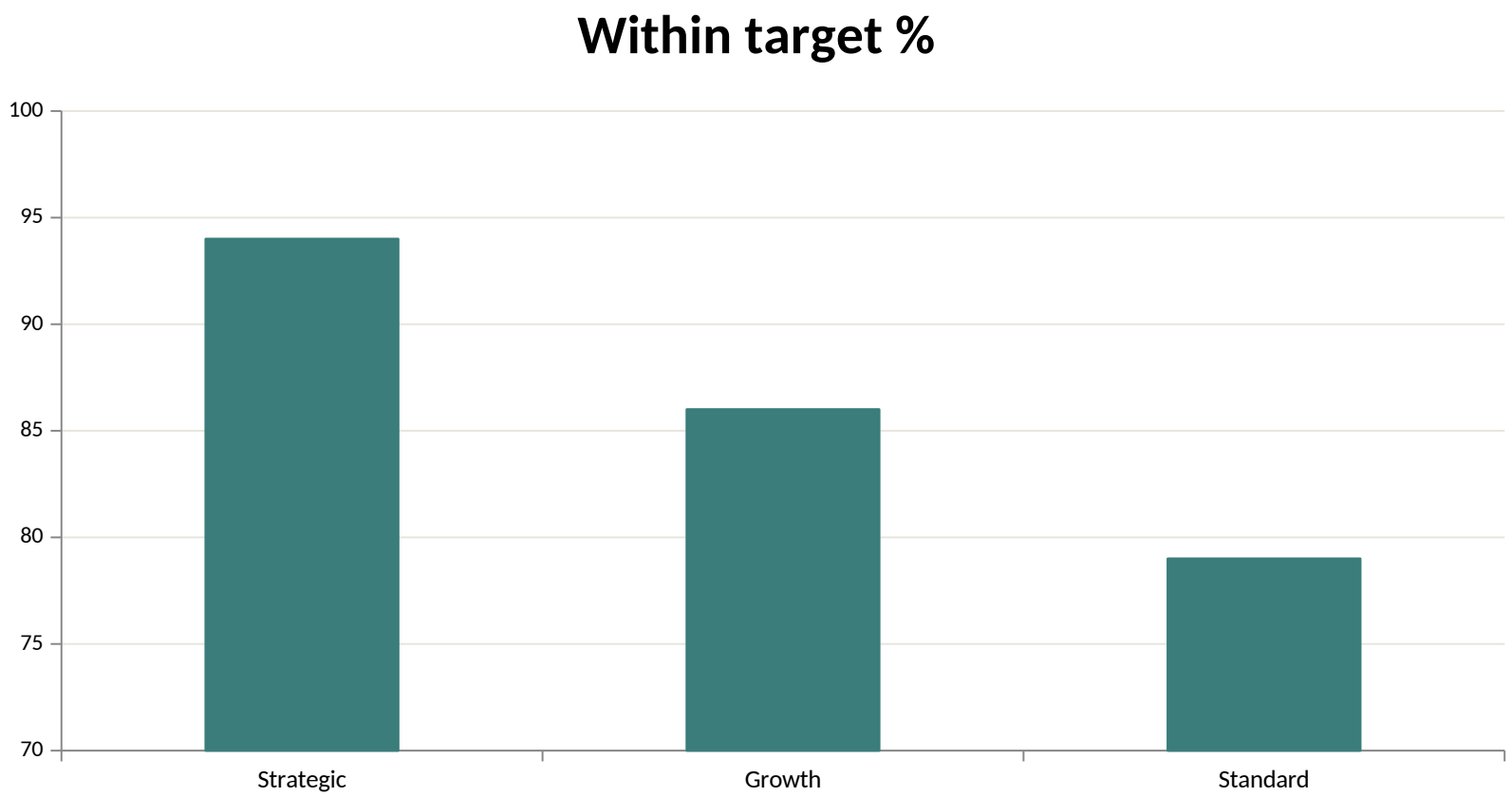
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Seventy percent from three partners warrants continuity planning and controlled diversification.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Communication SLA by Tier



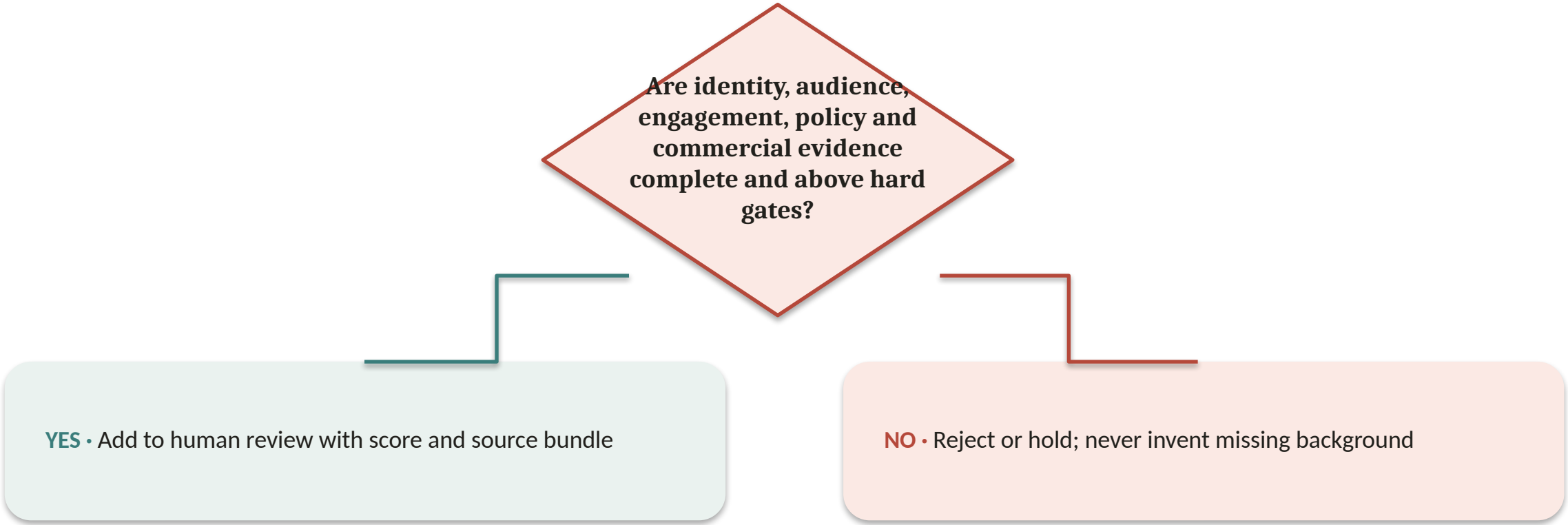
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

The scalable standard tier needs better self-service material or routing.

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DECISION RULE

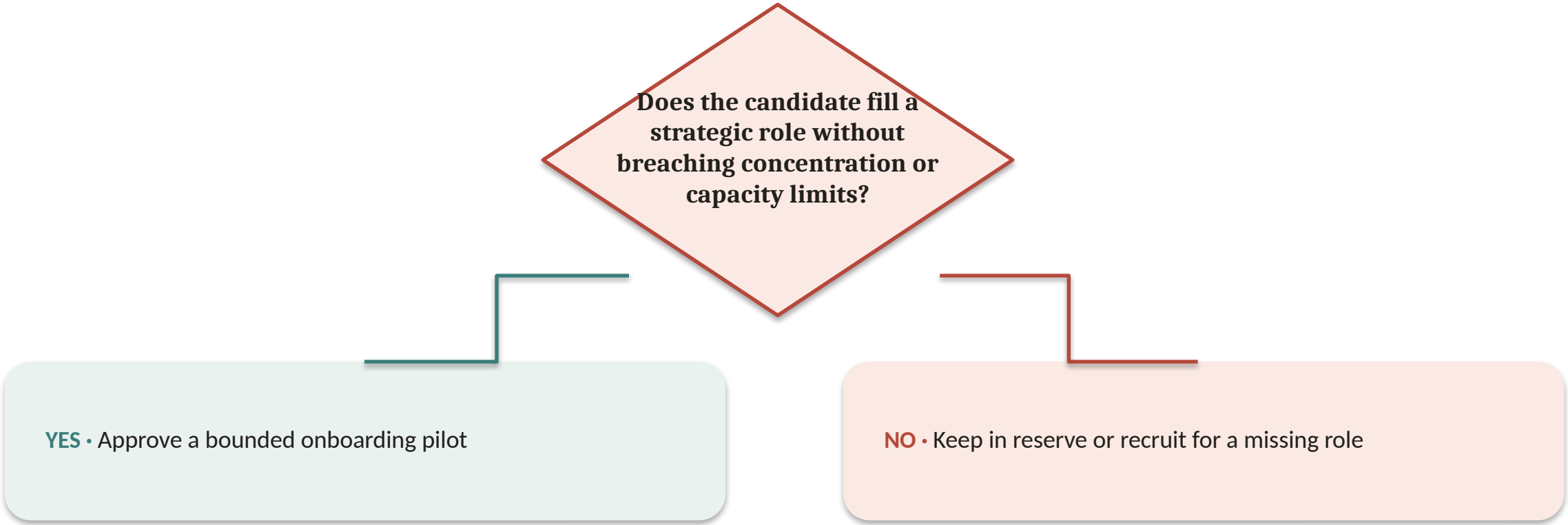
Shortlist a Candidate



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DECISION RULE

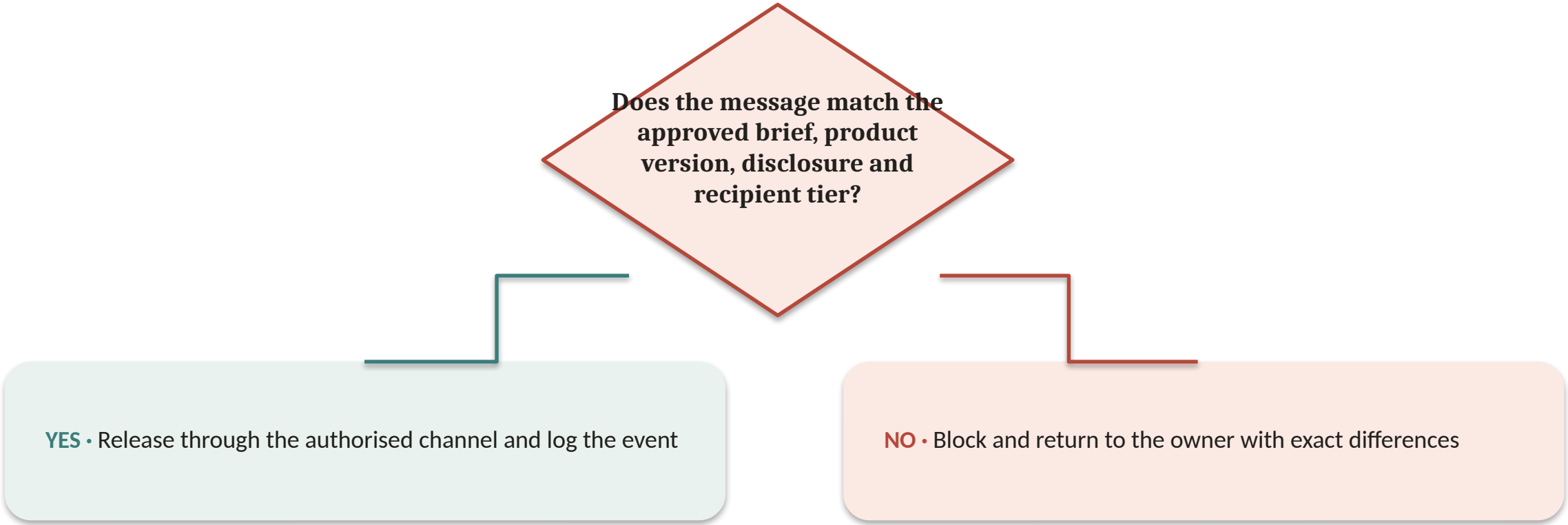
Add a Portfolio Partner



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DECISION RULE

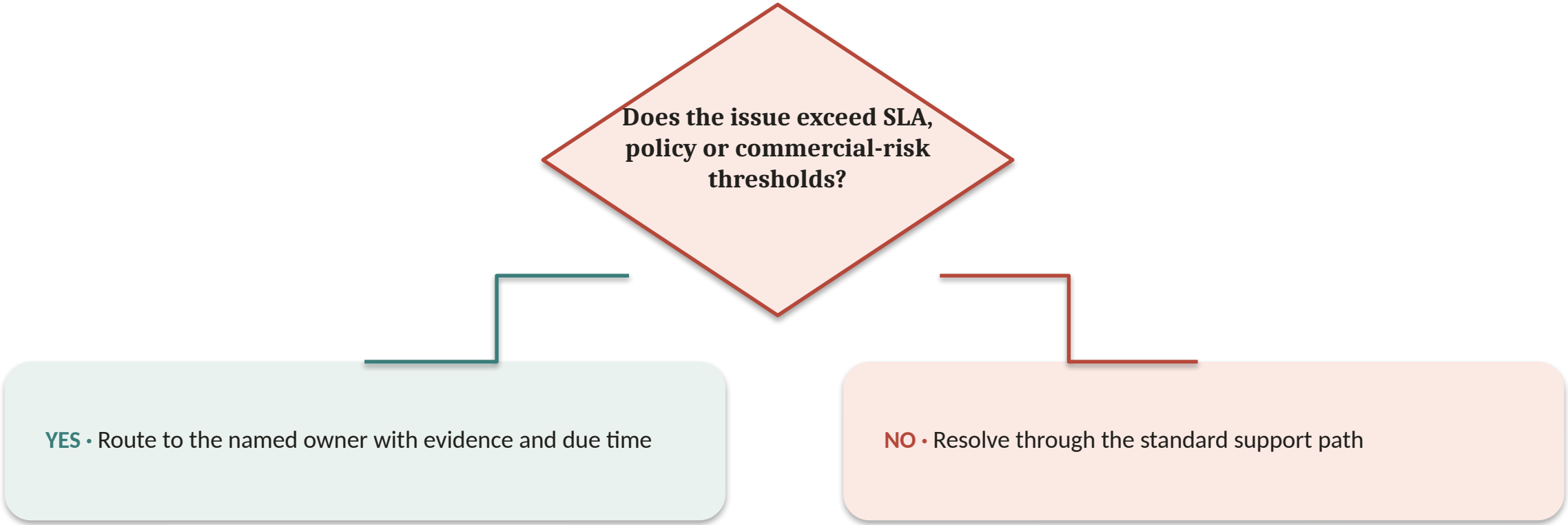
Send a Partner Message



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DECISION RULE

Escalate a Partner Issue



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FAILURE CONTROL

Due-Diligence Failure Modes

Identity	impersonation or unverifiable ownership
Audience	mismatch, bots or stale followers
Content	unsafe claims or weak disclosure
Reputation	undisclosed conflicts or complaints
Commercial	unverified results or reference gaps

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Portfolio Failure Modes

Concentration	revenue depends on few partners
Duplication	many partners reach the same audience
Role gap	no authority or retention partner
Capacity	team cannot support recruited volume
Cannibalisation	discounting shifts existing customers

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FAILURE CONTROL

Communication Failure Modes

Version drift	old offer or assets stay live
Channel sprawl	messages cannot be audited
SLA opacity	partners do not know response time
Agent overreach	unapproved promise or term
No closure	issues lack owner and outcome

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FAILURE CONTROL

MCP and Research Controls

Excess scope	connector sees unrelated records
Prompt injection	candidate page redirects agent
Source mix-up	facts attached to wrong partner
No audit ID	retrieval cannot be reproduced
Write surprise	research tool changes external state

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EVIDENCE

LO2 Evidence Bundle

1 Evidence 1

partner archetype and source plan

2 Evidence 2

candidate evidence records

3 Evidence 3

weighted scorecard

4 Evidence 4

portfolio role and concentration model

5 Evidence 5

versioned partner brief

6 Evidence 6

communication and escalation log

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Partner Review Pack

1 **Evidence 1**

identity and ownership evidence

2 **Evidence 2**

audience and engagement sample

3 **Evidence 3**

content and disclosure review

4 **Evidence 4**

policy and reputation flags

5 **Evidence 5**

commercial references

6 **Evidence 6**

human decision and conditions

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03

LAB 3

MCP-Assisted Partner Discovery and Due Diligence

LO2 | K2, K3, K7 | A3 · 120 minutes

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PRACTICE BRIDGE

Lab 3 Scenario

1 Business need

Use a read-only research workflow to collect and verify candidate background information, then produce a source-backed shortlist.

2 Deliverable

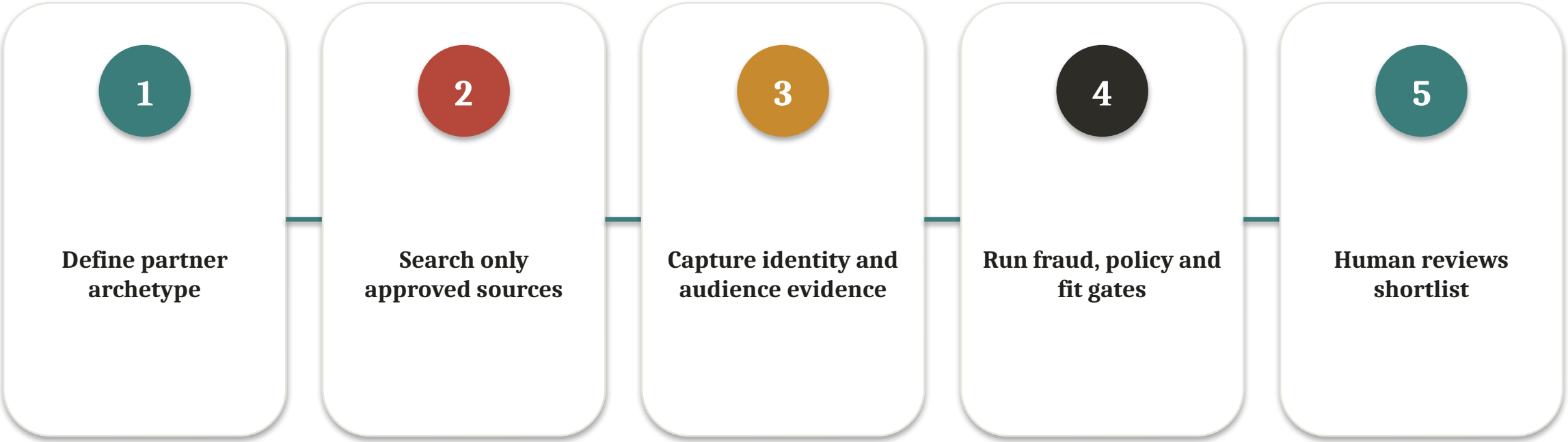
A partner evidence register, due-diligence report and explainable shortlist.

3 Tool boundary

Claude Cowork, read-only MCP/web research, CSV, Python scorecard

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Lab 3 Runtime Mechanism



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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WHAT MUST REMAIN TRUE

Lab 3 Concrete Contract

Rule 1	one row per candidate identity
Rule 2	facts retain direct source URLs
Rule 3	engagement uses a dated denominator
Rule 4	connector is read-only
Rule 5	missing evidence is never imputed

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WHAT TO CAPTURE

Lab 3 Evidence Package

1

Evidence 1

affiliate-candidates.csv

2

Evidence 2

source register

3

Evidence 3

due-diligence findings

4

Evidence 4

partner-scorecard.md

5

Evidence 5

human shortlist decision

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TEST WITHOUT CLICK PATHS

Lab 3 Verification and Failure

Accept

- ✓ connector boundary is read-only
- ✓ identity and audience evidence sourced
- ✓ hard gates exclude failures
- ✓ scores recompute
- ✓ human shortlist rationale recorded

Diagnose

- ✓ identity conflict blocks candidate
- ✓ bot-like engagement flags review
- ✓ source text cannot change instructions
- ✓ policy gate is non-compensable

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04

LAB 4

Affiliate Portfolio and Communication Agent

LO2 | A2 · 90 minutes

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PRACTICE BRIDGE

Lab 4 Scenario

1 Business need

Construct a role-balanced portfolio and a controlled communication cadence that keeps partner briefs, product updates and escalations traceable.

2 Deliverable

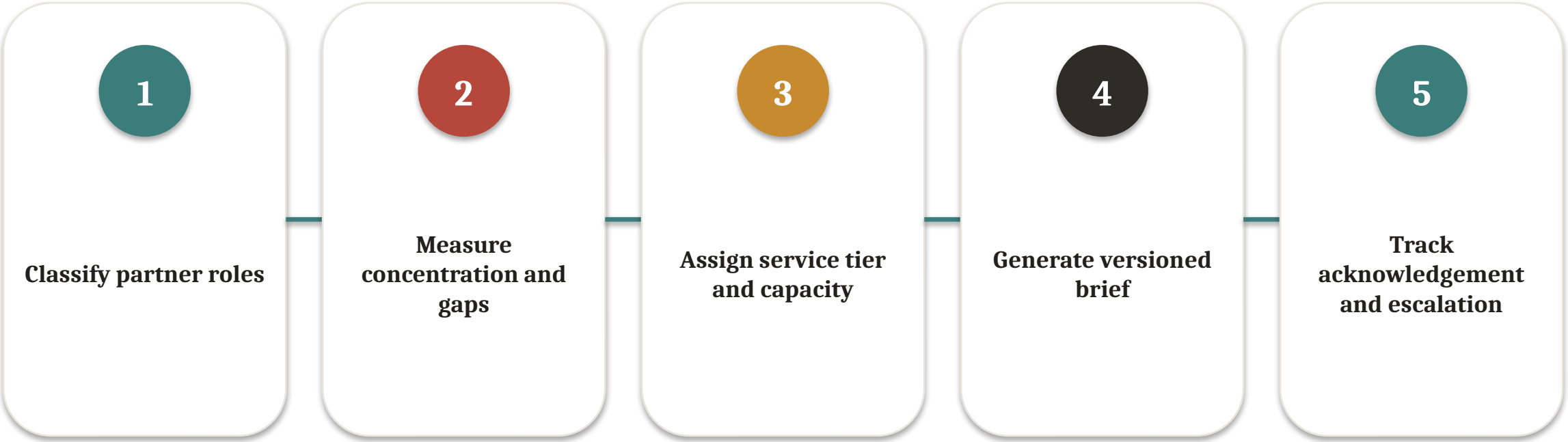
A portfolio mix model, tiered communication plan and versioned partner brief generated by a custom Skill.

3 Tool boundary

Claude Cowork, custom Skill, CSV portfolio model, Markdown brief templates

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Lab 4 Runtime Mechanism



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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WHAT MUST REMAIN TRUE

Lab 4 Concrete Contract

Rule 1	portfolio share totals 100%
Rule 2	top-3 concentration is visible
Rule 3	each partner has one owner
Rule 4	brief carries product and asset version
Rule 5	message event has outcome and next action

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WHAT TO CAPTURE

Lab 4 Evidence Package

1 **Evidence 1**

portfolio.csv

2 **Evidence 2**

portfolio-analysis.md

3 **Evidence 3**

communication-cadence.csv

4 **Evidence 4**

approved partner brief

5 **Evidence 5**

message and escalation log

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TEST WITHOUT CLICK PATHS

Lab 4 Verification and Failure

Accept

- ✓ portfolio shares reconcile
- ✓ concentration reported
- ✓ role gap identified
- ✓ brief versioned and approved
- ✓ SLA escalation works

Diagnose

- ✓ duplicate audience creates hidden concentration
- ✓ old brief version is blocked
- ✓ SLA miss triggers named escalation
- ✓ agent cannot change commercial terms

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03

TOPIC 03

Campaign Reporting, Compliance and Optimisation with Agentic AI

Tracked links -> event facts -> commission reconciliation -> policy checks -> controlled experiments

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Topic 03 Coverage

1 Mechanism 1

Preserve attribution grain from click and order events through commission settlement.

2 Mechanism 2

Calculate traffic, conversion, revenue, commission and ROI with explicit denominators.

3 Mechanism 3

Gate content and partner actions with disclosure, brand, privacy and policy controls.

4 Mechanism 4

Convert dashboard evidence into reversible tests with human ownership and guardrails.

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VISUAL MODEL

Attribution Evidence Drives Controlled Optimisation



Content
unique tracked links

Ledger
click, conversion and payout grain

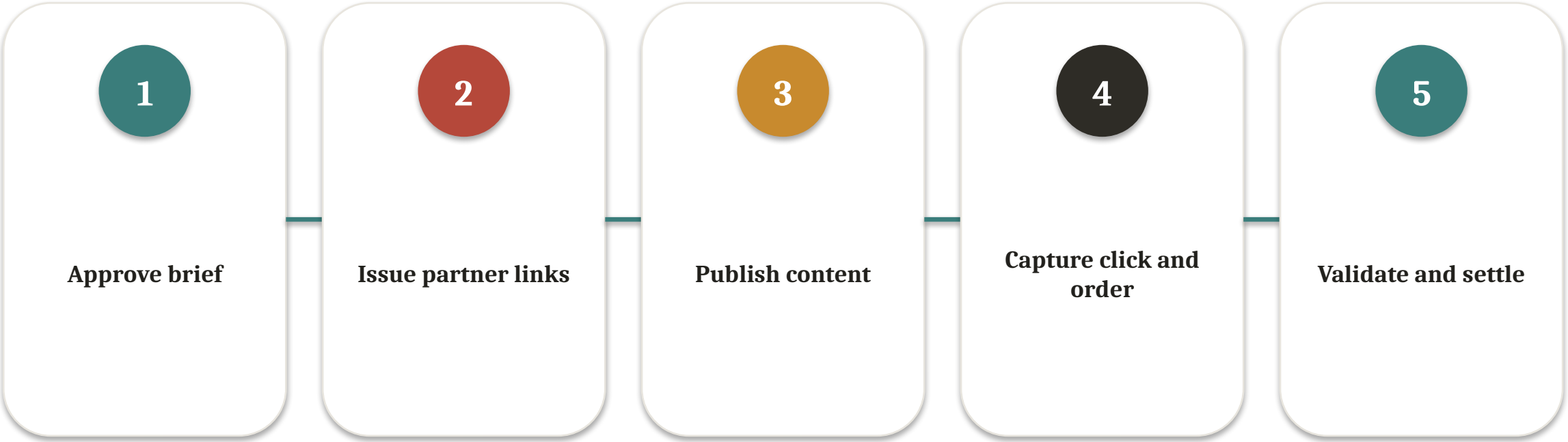
Dashboard
traffic, revenue and ROI

AI analyst
anomaly and hypothesis

Human owner
approve reversible change

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Campaign Runtime Trace

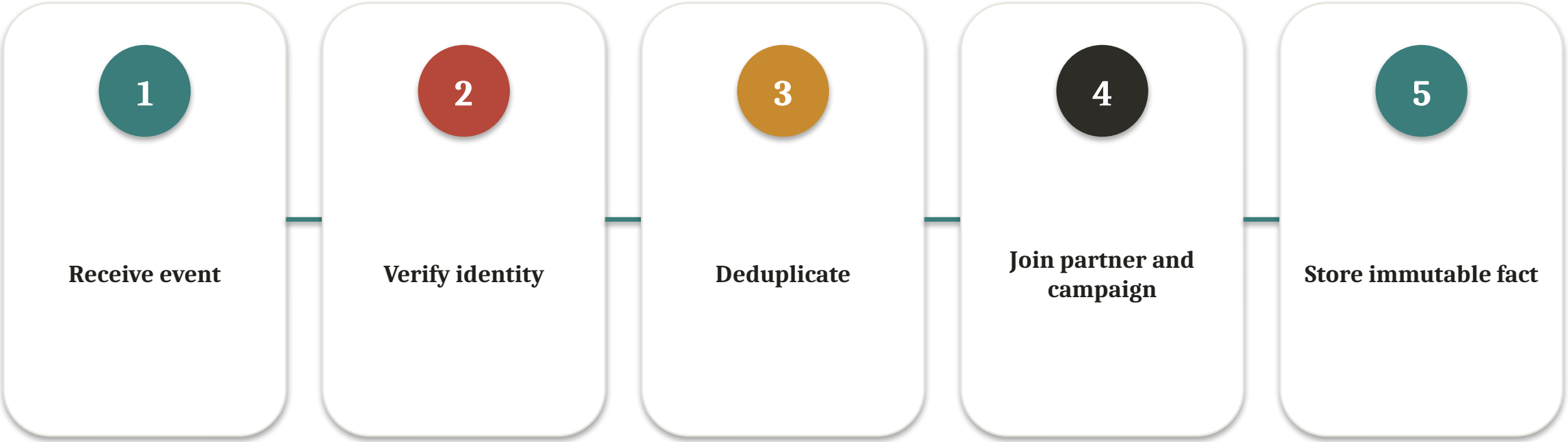


Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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RUNTIME TRACE

Attribution Event Pipeline

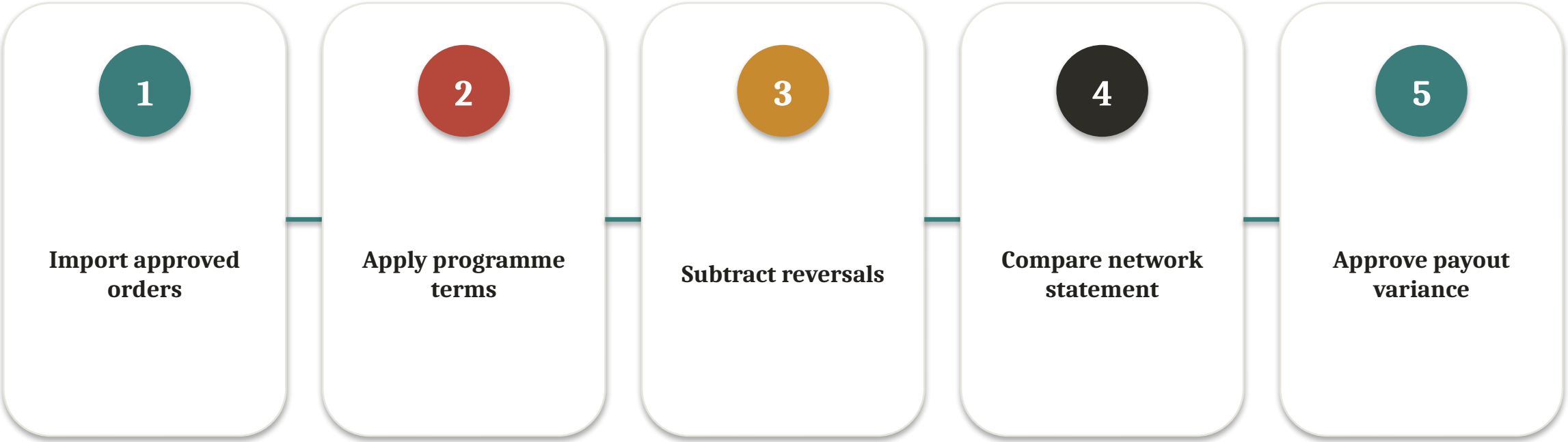


Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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RUNTIME TRACE

Commission Reconciliation



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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RUNTIME TRACE

Compliance Review Flow



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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RUNTIME TRACE

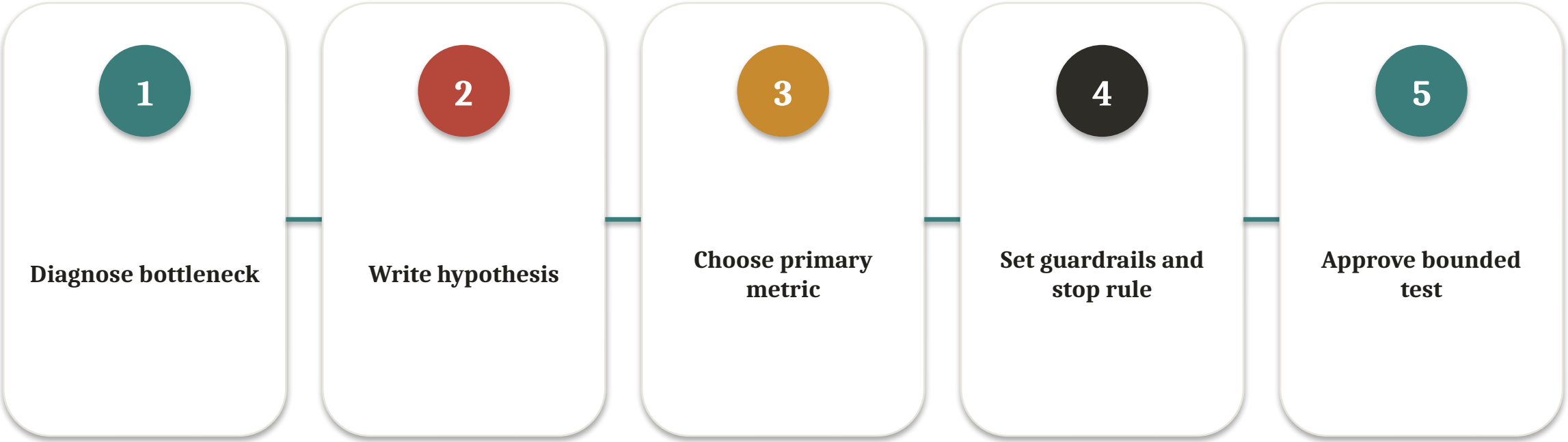
Agentic Reporting Loop



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Optimisation Experiment



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Tracked Link Contract

partner_id	affiliate identity
campaign_id	strategic initiative
creative_id	approved asset version
destination	allow-listed landing page
utm_fields	channel reporting labels
issued_at	traceable link version

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Click Event Fact

click_id	deduplication key
occurred_at	UTC event time
partner_id	source affiliate
campaign_id	linked campaign
landing_page	approved destination
consent_state	lawful tracking boundary

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Conversion Event Fact

order_id	merchant transaction key
click_id	attribution join
approved_revenue	net eligible amount
status	pending | approved | reversed
commission	calculated liability
validated_at	merchant decision time

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Campaign KPI Dictionary

metric	human-readable name
numerator	event or money field
denominator	eligible population
grain	partner, campaign and period
exclusions	bots, reversals or invalid traffic
owner	definition steward

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Compliance Finding

finding_id	stable review key
rule_id	policy or legal requirement
evidence_span	exact content location
severity	low | medium | high
resolution	change, accept or reject
reviewer	human decision owner

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CONCRETE CONTRACT

Affiliate Progress Report

period	reporting window
performance	traffic, conversion and revenue
compliance	findings and status
portfolio_summary	active partners and mix
commission	gross, reversal and payable
actions	owner, due date and expected effect

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WORKED CALCULATION

Click-Through Rate

CTR = affiliate-link clicks / eligible content impressions

REALISTIC INPUTS

4,200 / 120,000 = 3.5%

DECISION

Impressions must use the same content, audience and window as clicks.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Approved Conversion Rate

CVR = approved conversions / unique tracked clicks

REALISTIC INPUTS

168 / 4,200 = 4.0%

DECISION

Pending or reversed orders do not prove completed commercial value.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Average Order Value

AOV = approved revenue / approved orders

REALISTIC INPUTS

$23,520 / 168 = $140

DECISION

Segment by product and new/existing customer before applying one average to forecasts.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Commission Rate

Effective commission rate = payable commission / approved revenue

REALISTIC INPUTS

$2,688 / $23,520 = 11.43%

DECISION

Tier bonuses and exclusions can make the effective rate differ from the headline rate.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Affiliate ROI

ROI = (attributed gross profit - commission - programme cost) / programme cost

REALISTIC INPUTS

($9,408 - $2,688 - $2,000) / $2,000 = 236%

DECISION

Use gross profit, not revenue, and disclose attribution assumptions.

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WORKED CALCULATION

Variance Threshold

Variance % = (actual - plan) / plan

REALISTIC INPUTS

($23,520 - $20,000) / $20,000 = 17.6%

DECISION

Materiality is an approved threshold; an agent should not invent it after seeing results.

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COMPARE

First-Click vs Last-Click

First-click

- ✓ Credits discovery source
- ✓ Useful for acquisition analysis
- ✓ Ignores closing influence

Last-click

- ✓ Credits final touch
- ✓ Common and operationally simple
- ✓ Ignores earlier assistance

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COMPARE

Gross vs Approved Conversion

Gross

- ✓ Fast leading signal
- ✓ Includes pending and fraud
- ✓ Overstates payable value

Approved

- ✓ Validated merchant outcome
- ✓ Supports settlement
- ✓ Arrives with delay

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COMPARE

Platform Dashboard vs Reconciled Ledger

Platform

- ✓ Quick operational view
- ✓ Uses network definitions
- ✓ May omit merchant reversals

Reconciled

- ✓ Joins merchant truth
- ✓ Supports finance and payout
- ✓ Needs identity and timing controls

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COMPARE

Disclosure Present vs Disclosure Clear

Present

- ✓ Words exist somewhere
- ✓ May be hidden after click
- ✓ Can fail consumer understanding

Clear

- ✓ Prominent before endorsement
- ✓ Plain language
- ✓ Matches channel context

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COMPARE

Agent Narrative vs Deterministic Metric

Agent narrative

- ✓ Explains patterns and hypotheses
- ✓ Useful for stakeholder reading
- ✓ Can overstate causality

Deterministic metric

- ✓ Recomputable formula
- ✓ Explicit fields and denominator
- ✓ Source of record for decisions

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COMPARE

Optimisation vs Policy Override

Optimisation

- ✓ Changes creative, mix or cadence
- ✓ Bounded test and guardrails
- ✓ Owner can reverse

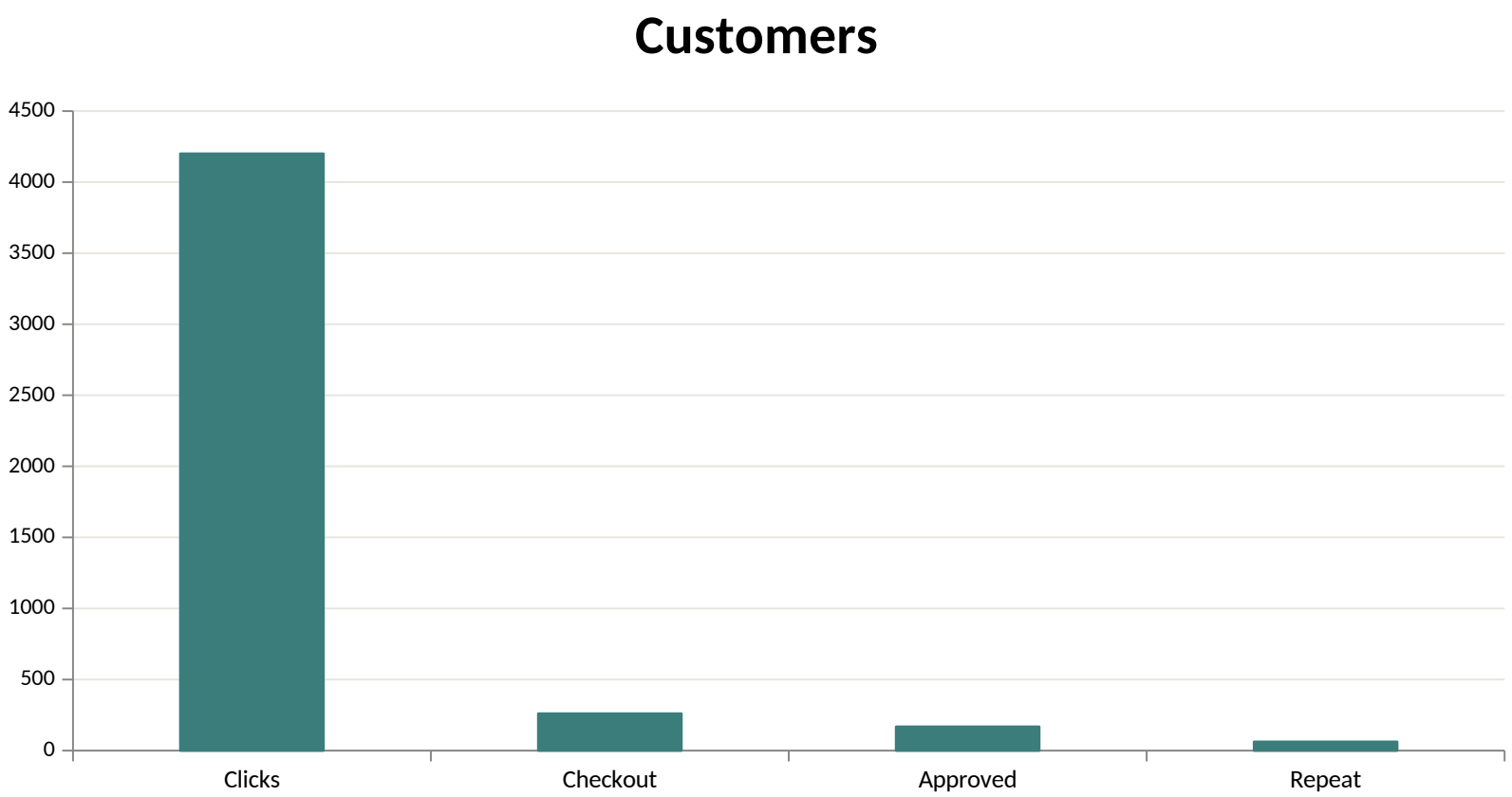
Policy override

- ✓ Weakens disclosure or controls
- ✓ Not a performance lever
- ✓ Requires governance decision, usually reject

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Affiliate Funnel



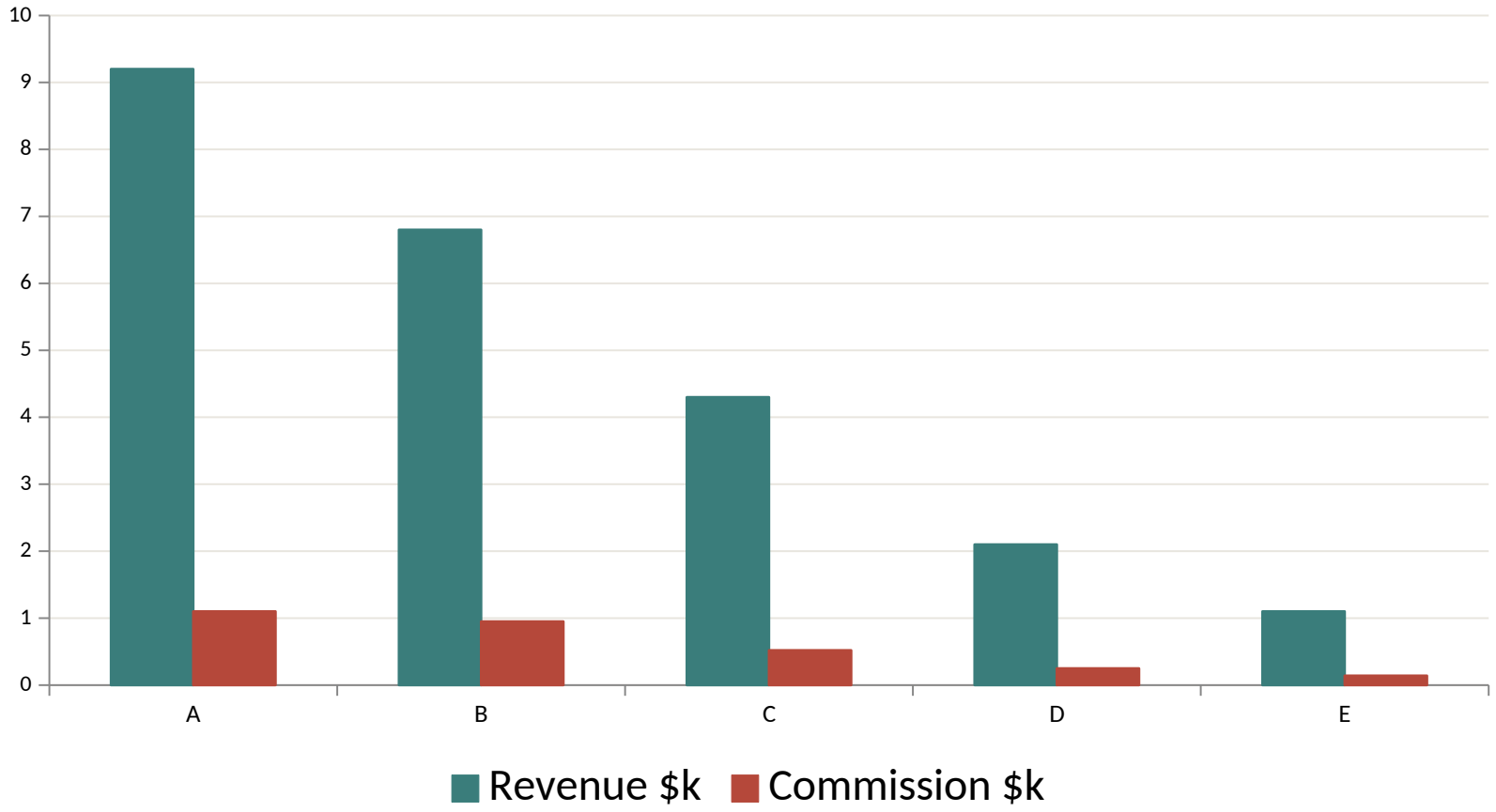
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Checkout-to-approved loss should be split into abandonment, fraud, cancellation and return causes.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Revenue and Commission by Partner



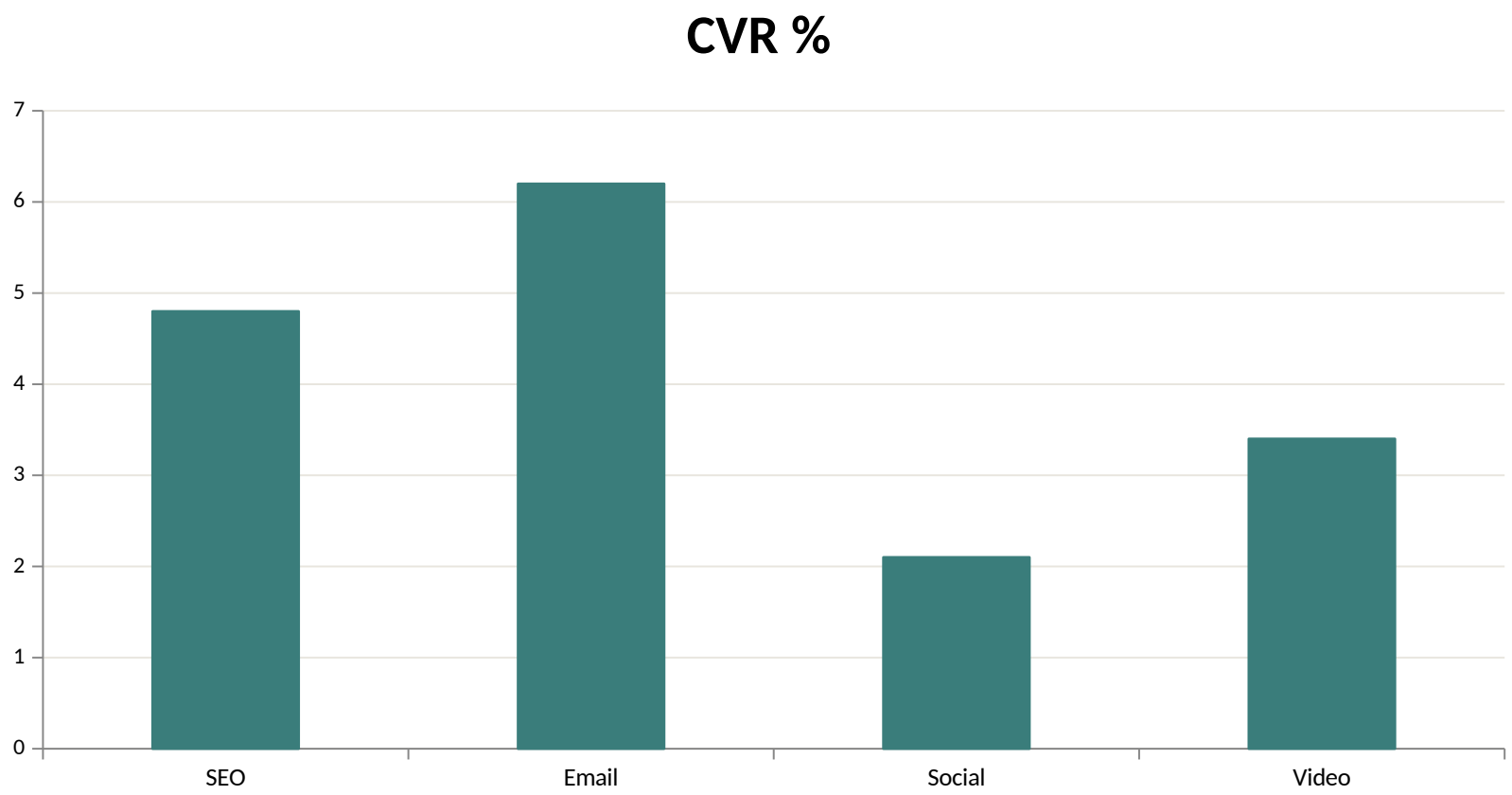
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Partner B has a higher effective commission burden than Partner A despite lower revenue.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Conversion Rate by Channel



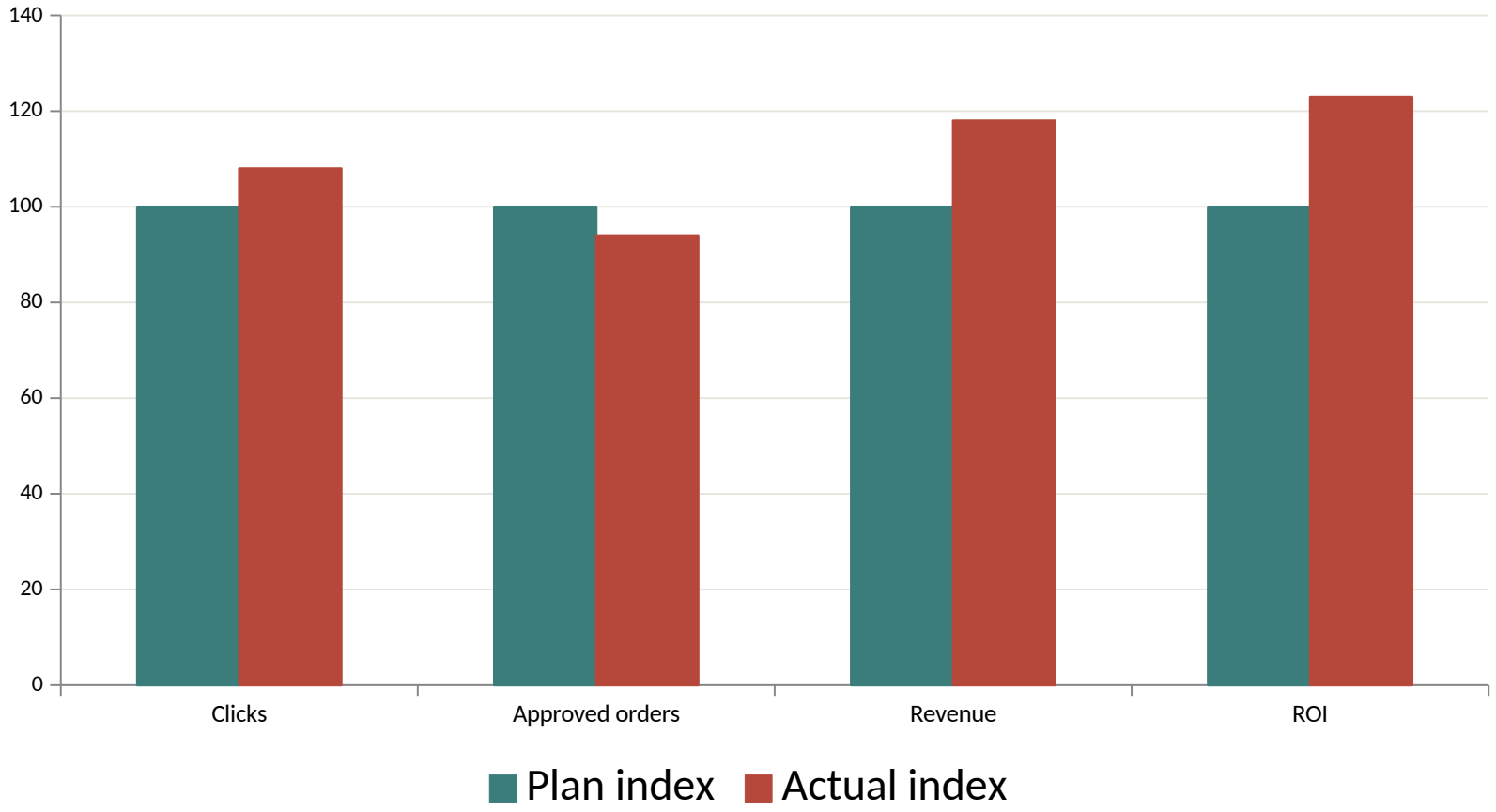
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Channel mix changes can move the blended conversion rate without any content-quality change.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Performance Against Plan



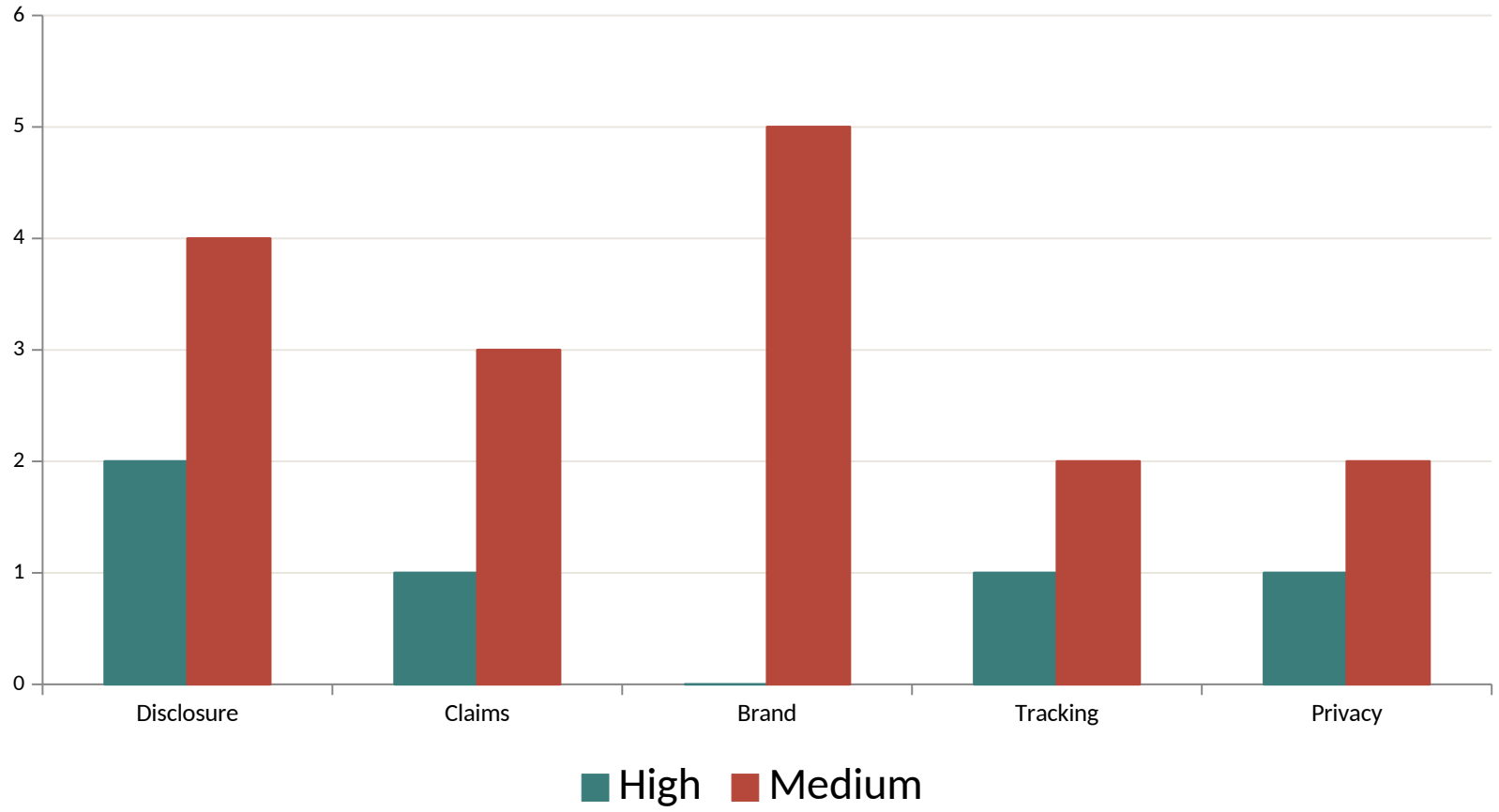
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

More clicks produced fewer approved orders, but larger baskets lifted revenue and ROI.

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NATIVE PPT CHART

Compliance Findings by Severity



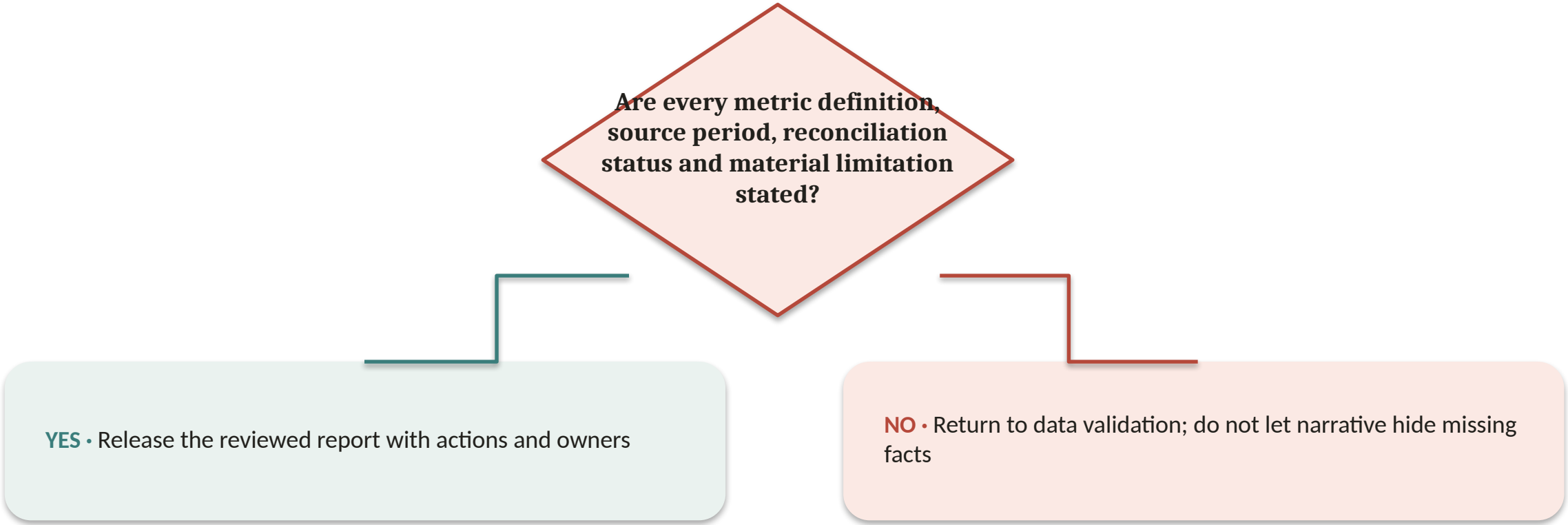
WHAT THE DATA SHOWS

Disclosure is the first remediation priority because it has the most high-severity findings.

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DECISION RULE

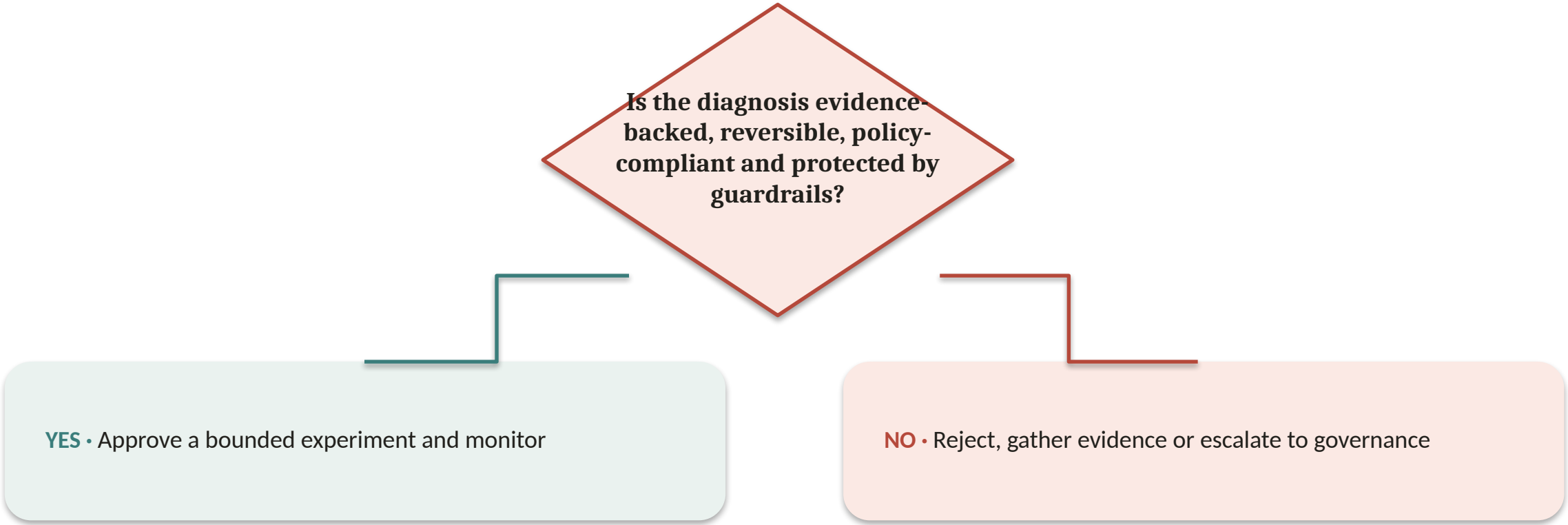
Publish a Campaign Report



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DECISION RULE

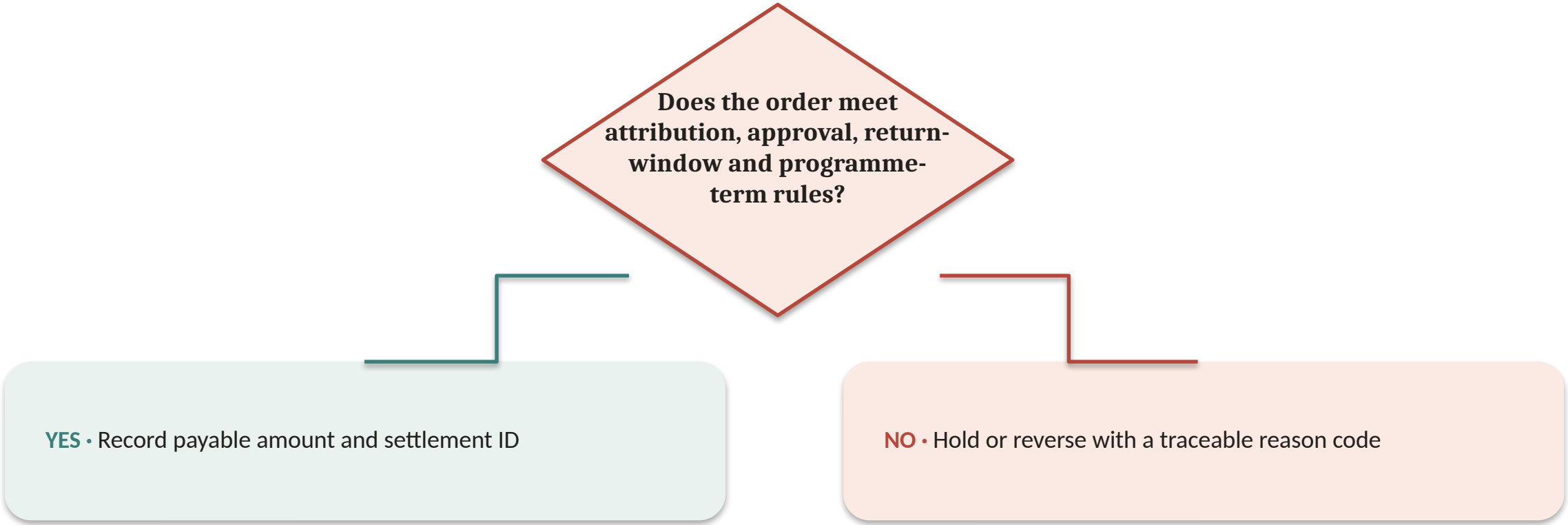
Approve an Optimisation



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DECISION RULE

Pay a Commission



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FAILURE CONTROL

Attribution Failure Modes

Duplicate click	retry counted twice
Broken join	order lacks click or partner key
Window mismatch	conversion outside terms
Cross-device gap	journey cannot be linked
Consent breach	tracking beyond lawful boundary

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FAILURE CONTROL

Reporting Failure Modes

Metric drift	same label, changed formula
Gross value	reversals omitted
Blended average	segment weakness hidden
Narrative inflation	correlation stated as cause
No owner	recommendation never closes

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FAILURE CONTROL

Compliance Failure Modes

Hidden disclosure	affiliate relationship unclear
Unsupported claim	evidence absent or stale
Brand drift	partner changes mandatory message
Privacy misuse	personal data copied to tools
Agent release	content publishes without human approval

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EVIDENCE

LO3 Evidence Bundle

1

Evidence 1

tracked-link register

2

Evidence 2

validated click and conversion facts

3

Evidence 3

commission reconciliation

4

Evidence 4

KPI dictionary and dashboard

5

Evidence 5

compliance findings and resolution

6

Evidence 6

approved progress report and experiment

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Management Report Reading Order

1 **Evidence 1**

decision and period

2 **Evidence 2**

portfolio and campaign status

3 **Evidence 3**

performance versus plan

4 **Evidence 4**

commission and reconciliation

5 **Evidence 5**

compliance and limitations

6 **Evidence 6**

actions, owners and due dates

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05

LAB 5

Brand-Aligned Multi-Channel Campaign Factory

LO3 | K4, K8, K9 · 90 minutes

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PRACTICE BRIDGE

Lab 5 Scenario

1 Business need

Use a bounded content Skill to produce website, email, social and video briefs from one approved campaign contract, with disclosure and claim controls.

2 Deliverable

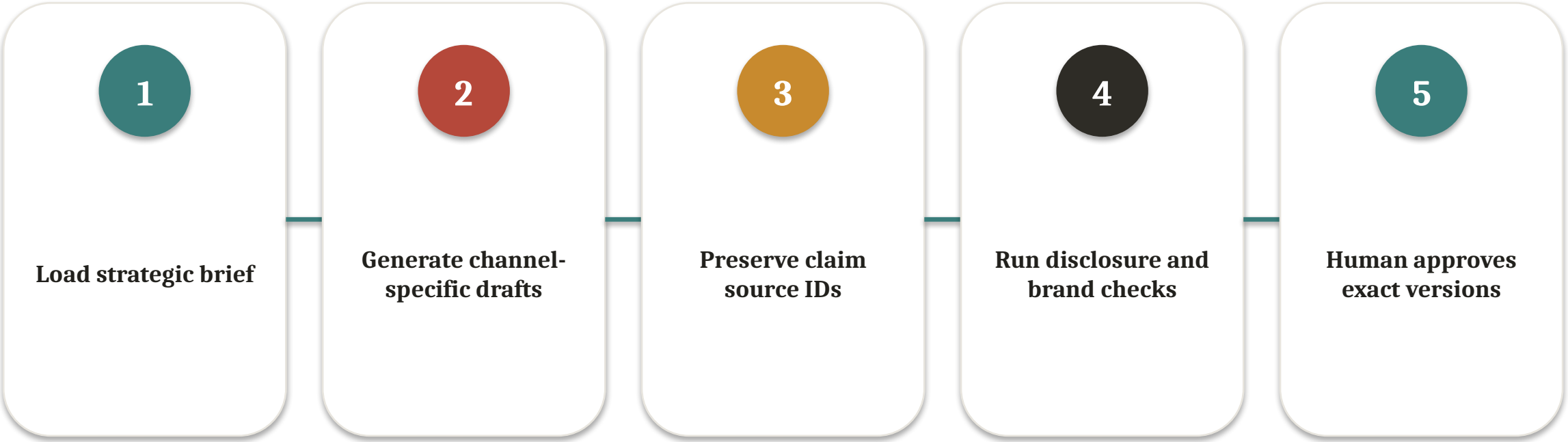
A machine-readable campaign brief, four channel artifacts and a compliance release report.

3 Tool boundary

Claude Cowork, custom Skill, JSON schema, deterministic compliance checker

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Lab 5 Runtime Mechanism



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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WHAT MUST REMAIN TRUE

Lab 5 Concrete Contract

Rule 1	one campaign objective
Rule 2	one primary CTA per artifact
Rule 3	tracked links identify channel and partner
Rule 4	affiliate disclosure is prominent
Rule 5	all factual claims cite approved sources

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WHAT TO CAPTURE

Lab 5 Evidence Package

1 **Evidence 1**

campaign-brief.json

2 **Evidence 2**

four channel drafts

3 **Evidence 3**

compliance-report.json

4 **Evidence 4**

resolved findings

5 **Evidence 5**

human approval hashes

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Lab 5 Verification and Failure

Accept

- ✓ brief passes schema
- ✓ four channel artifacts created
- ✓ claims trace to sources
- ✓ disclosure passes
- ✓ human approval hashes recorded

Diagnose

- ✓ channel draft cannot alter offer terms
- ✓ missing disclosure blocks release
- ✓ unsupported superlative is flagged
- ✓ brand and legal issues are separate

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06

LAB 6

Attribution, Commission and Performance Reporting Agent

LO3 | A4 · 135 minutes

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PRACTICE BRIDGE

Lab 6 Scenario

1 Business need

Validate click and conversion facts, reconcile commission statements, calculate campaign KPIs and generate an evidence-led management report with controlled recommendations.

2 Deliverable

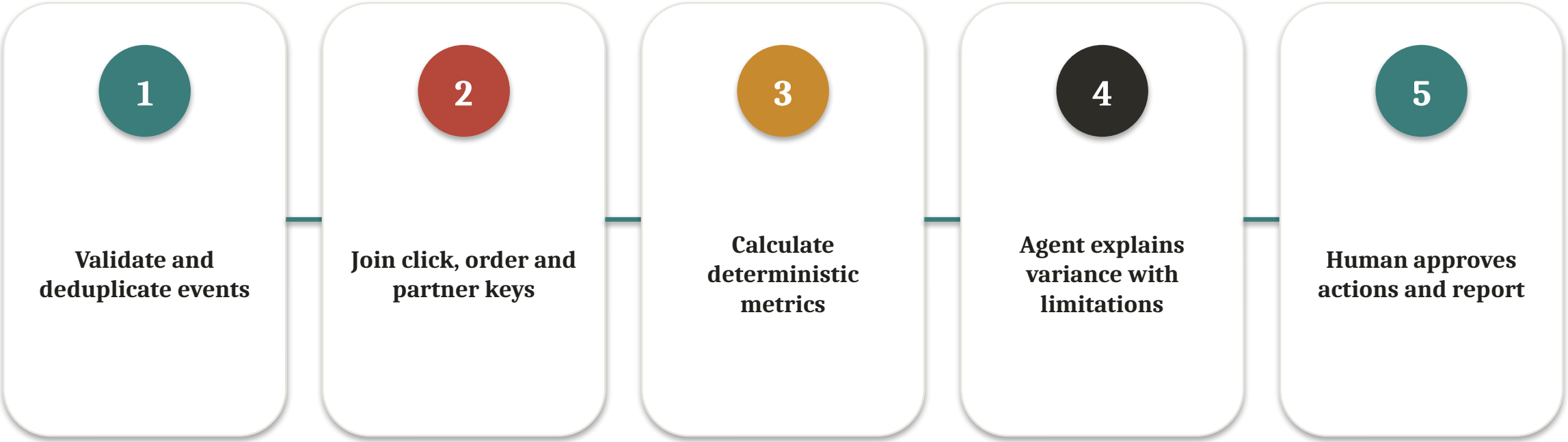
A reconciled event ledger, KPI dashboard, commission variance report and approved partner progress report.

3 Tool boundary

Claude Cowork, CSV event data, Python reconciliation/report scripts, HTML dashboard

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Lab 6 Runtime Mechanism



Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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WHAT MUST REMAIN TRUE

Lab 6 Concrete Contract

Rule 1	immutable event identifiers
Rule 2	approved revenue excludes reversals
Rule 3	metric dictionary fixes denominators
Rule 4	commission terms are effective-dated
Rule 5	recommendations state owner and guardrails

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WHAT TO CAPTURE

Lab 6 Evidence Package

1 **Evidence 1**

click-events.csv

2 **Evidence 2**

conversion-events.csv

3 **Evidence 3**

commission-statement.csv

4 **Evidence 4**

reconciliation-report.md

5 **Evidence 5**

dashboard.html

6 **Evidence 6**

approved-progress-report.md

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TEST WITHOUT CLICK PATHS

Lab 6 Verification and Failure

Accept

- ✓ event validation passes
- ✓ commission variance resolved or explained
- ✓ metrics recompute
- ✓ dashboard and report generated
- ✓ recommendation has guardrails and owner

Diagnose

- ✓ duplicate events are quarantined
- ✓ unmatched orders remain unresolved
- ✓ commission variance exceeds threshold
- ✓ small samples lower confidence

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COURSE CLOSE

From Evidence to Assessment

Review the control loop, complete the assessment and preserve your working artifacts

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LO1 -> LO2 -> LO3

Revision Map

1

Research

Labs 1-2: offer economics, trend evidence and product updates

2

Coordinate

Labs 3-4: due diligence, portfolio and partner communications

3

Report

Labs 5-6: campaign control, attribution, commission and optimisation

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COURSE SYNTHESIS

What You Achieved

1

Evidence-led research

Trace every market and partner claim to a source

2

Reusable agent workflows

Package repeatable work in bounded Skills and connectors

3

Controlled growth

Approve content, communication, payout and optimisation decisions

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Courseware and Assessment on the LMS

1 **Download**

Open the course run and download the current slides, Learner Guide and labs

2 **Complete**

Open the assigned WA and Case Study papers

3 **Submit**

Upload completed answers to the LMS before the deadline

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Support

1 Email

enquiry@tertiaryinfotech.com

2 Telephone

+65 6100 0613

3 Course page

https://www.tertiarycourses.com.sg/wsq-agentic-ai-for-affiliate-marketing.html

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OPEN BOOK · 2 HOURS

Assessment Reminder

WA-SAQ · Knowledge

- ✓ K1-K9 from the deck and LG
- ✓ Three open-ended LO-grouped questions
- ✓ Use exact contracts, formulas and controls

Case Study · Ability

- ✓ A1-A5 from the labs
- ✓ Three integrated tasks
- ✓ Show evidence, decisions and verification

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FINAL CHECK

Assessment Flow

1. **TRAQOM attendance**
2. **Assessment attendance**
3. **Complete WA-SAQ**
4. **Complete Case Study**
5. **Upload on LMS and sign record**

Read left to right. Each boundary has a named payload, state transition and owner.

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Digital Attendance (Mandatory)

1 **AM**

Attendance recorded

2 **PM**

Attendance recorded

3 **Assessment**

Complete the final SSG attendance event

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Thank You

Build agentic campaigns that are useful, measurable and controlled.

TGS-2025060552